Confession Page Narratives and Their Implications for a Diplomatic Communication System

An Undergraduate Thesis

Presented to

the **COLLEGE OF ARTS AND SCIENCES**

CEBU TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY - ARGAO CAMPUS

Argao, Cebu, Philippines

In Partial Fulfillment

Of the Requirements for the Degree

BACHELOR OF ARTS IN LITERATURE

By:

Aguitong, Claire

Albiso, Maria Salome

Delposo, Sharmaine

Olivar, Oliver Kent

MAY 2026

ABSTRACT

Anonymous digital spaces like confession pages are increasingly important for understanding students' emotional, academic, and social experiences. However, there is a gap in research examining how these platforms function as informal mechanisms of feedback and diplomatic communication. This study aimed to explore how anonymous posts on the CTU Confession Page reveal narrative structures, emotional disclosure, and identity negotiation, and to develop a framework for interpreting these narratives as a Narrative Diplomatic Communication System. Using a qualitative content analysis design, fifteen posts were selected and analyzed as individual units, coded inductively for narrative form, thematic content, disclosure depth, anonymity, and communicative strategies, and grouped into broader themes. Key findings indicate that students use confessional, reflective, and adversarial narratives to convey academic stress, mental health challenges, institutional critiques, and identity concerns, with anonymity enabling deeper emotional disclosure. Diplomatic communication markers, including softened critique, empathic framing, and reflective positioning, were also evident, illustrating students' careful negotiation of self-expression in public yet anonymous contexts. These findings suggest that anonymous digital narratives provide valuable insights into student experiences and institutional climate, offering guidance for developing supportive academic policies and interventions. The proposed Narrative Diplomatic Communication System demonstrates how online narratives can be systematically interpreted to inform student support, institutional responsiveness, and engagement strategies, highlighting the practical and theoretical relevance of studying anonymous digital platforms within higher education contexts.

Keywords: *Anonymous digital narratives, emotional disclosure, Narrative Diplomatic Communication System.*

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

First and foremost, we, Claire Aguitong, Maria Salome Albiso, Sharmaine Delposo, and Oliver Kent Olivar, express our deepest gratitude to the Almighty for providing us with the strength, wisdom, and perseverance to complete this thesis. Your guidance sustained us through late nights, challenges, and the rigorous demands of research.

We are profoundly grateful to our families, whose unwavering love, support, and encouragement formed the foundation of our perseverance. Your sacrifices, words of motivation, and patience inspired us to keep pushing forward even during the most challenging moments.

To our research adviser, Dr. Luiscel Teofi E. Cabico, we extend our heartfelt thanks for his expert guidance, constructive critiques, and steadfast support throughout the study. Your mentorship and patience greatly enriched our academic journey and helped us navigate the complexities of this research.

We also sincerely thank our research chairperson, Dr. Anesito L. Cutillas, for providing leadership and administrative oversight, ensuring the smooth and ethical progression of this research.

Our deepest appreciation goes to our panelists and instructors, Dr. Ma. Cristilina A. Montañez, Dr. Rachel S. Camilo, Dr. Marcelina S. Deiparine, and Mr. Wyndel Joseph

Olita, whose critical evaluations, insightful recommendations, and encouragement strengthened the academic merit of this thesis.

We are also grateful to the administrators and moderators of the CTU Confession Page for granting access to the anonymous narratives that formed the core of this study. Your cooperation made it possible to understand the voices of students and their digital expressions.

To all who have directly or indirectly contributed to this research, your support, guidance, and encouragement were essential in transforming this thesis from an idea into completed work.

DEDICATION

We, Claire Aguitong, Maria Salome Albiso, Sharmaine Delposo, and Oliver Kent Olivar, wholeheartedly dedicate this thesis to our beloved families. Your endless support, love, and sacrifices have been our anchor throughout this journey. Every word written in this study carries the inspiration drawn from your faith in us and your unwavering belief in our dreams.

To our mentors and teachers, we dedicate our gratitude and this work. Your patience, guidance, and encouragement challenged us to think deeply, persevere through difficulties, and strive for excellence. The lessons you imparted went beyond the classroom; they shaped our values, our curiosity, and our passion for learning.

To our fellow students at Cebu Technological University, whose anonymous narratives on the CTU Confession Page sparked the heart of this research, we dedicated our study. Your courage to share personal experiences, struggles, and reflections inspired us to explore the voices behind the words and to recognize the power of storytelling as a bridge between individuals and institutions.

Finally, we dedicate this thesis to the spirit of discovery, empathy, and understanding. May this work stand as a testament to the importance of listening, valuing diverse perspectives, and fostering meaningful connections within our academic community and beyond.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

TITLE PAGE i

ABSTRACT ii

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT iv

DEDICATION vi

TABLE OF CONTENTS vii

LIST OF TABLES x

LIST OF FIGURES xi

CHAPTER 1 THE PROBLEM AND ITS DESIGN

Introduction

Rationale of the Study 1

Philosophical Stance 3

Review of Related Literature 5

The Problem

Statement of the Problem 15

Significance of the Study 16

Research Methodology

Reflexivity Statement 19

Research Design 19

Environment 20

Data Source and Sampling 21

Instrument 22

Analytical Rules 22

Data Gathering Procedures 23

Ethical Considerations 24

Definition of Terms 25

CHAPTER 2 PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS, AND INTERPRETATION

Narrative Structures: Telling Their Stories from the Sidelines 27

Self-Expression and Emotional Negotiation: Carrying Emotional Weight and Finding Words for It 31

Anonymity as a Condition for Emotional Disclosure 35

Diplomatic Communication Markers in the Confession Posts 39

CHAPTER 3 SUMMARY OF FINDINGS, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Summary of Findings 44

Conclusion 45

Recommendations 47

CHAPTER 4 OUTPUT: THE NARRATIVE DIPLOMATIC COMMUNICATION SYSTEM

Rationale 49

Objectives 50

Scheme of Implementation 51

Bibliography 53

Appendices

Appendix A – Approval Letter/Admin Permission Letter 62

Appendix B – Transmittal Letter 64

Appendix C – Certificate of Validity 65

Appendix D – Research Instrument/Coding Manual 66

Appendix E – Summarized Confession Posts 72

Appendix F – Code-to-Theme Matrix 76

Appendix G – Documentation 86

Appendix H – Audit Trail 88

Curriculum Vitae 92

LIST OF TABLES

Table	Title	Page
1	Narrative Structure Codes of the Selected Confession Posts	28
2	Self-Expression Themes and Depth of Disclosure	31
3	Anonymity Function Codes	36
4	Diplomatic Communication Codes	39
5	Scheme of Implementation for the Narrative Diplomatic Communication System	51

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure	Title	Page
1	CTU Confession Page	20
2	CTU Confession Admin’s Team	21

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

The digital era has transformed how people connect and share information. Within this environment, Facebook “confession pages” have become popular, though unofficial, forums for students at colleges and universities, including Cebu Technological University (CTU), to express their opinions (Wangchuk, 2018; Abd Rahman, 2018). Because these pages allow for complete anonymity, they function as virtual “freedom walls,” giving students the confidence to reveal personal issues, mental health struggles, and even critical feedback about the school without fear of being identified or punished (Laor, 2025; Levontin & Yom-Tov, 2017). This study is significant because it explores how digital anonymity creates a space for indirect communication, offering a rare look into the unfiltered emotional world of students in a modern, tech-driven academic environment.

While these insights highlight the multifaceted role of confession pages as spaces for self-expression, anonymity, and indirect dialogue, existing scholarship remains limited in scope. Much of the literature continues to frame confession pages primarily as social utilities for information exchange, emotional support, and peer connection (Rodriguez et al., 2023; Lorenzana & Soriano, 2021; Belmonte et al., 2024). Although these functions are significant, they overlook the broader communicative dimension in which confession narratives operate as informal channels between students and institutions. For instance, Sacks, Gressier, and Maldon (2021) demonstrated that confession pages can serve as valuable data resources for academic support services, yet their findings stop short of analyzing how these anonymous disclosures might shape institutional dialogue. Similarly, Amador and Amador (2014) showed that social media platforms provide opportunities for students to seek help and indirectly communicate with advisors, but they did not extend this to the diplomatic implications of indirect critique and negotiation.

Moreover, while anonymity has been widely studied as a mechanism for fostering intimacy and honest disclosure (Ma et al., 2016; Levontin & Yom-Tov, 2017; Nguyen et al., 2021), fewer studies have examined how anonymity enables students to strategically frame their concerns in ways that resemble diplomatic communication. Laor (2025) and Zhu (2025) noted that anonymous confession posts often employ emotional appeals and reflective positioning to avoid direct confrontation, yet these practices have not been systematically connected to theories of negotiation and conflict management. In the broader field of communication, Melissen (2013) emphasized that diplomacy relies on indirectness and careful choice of words to maintain dialogue, while Voss et al. (2023) highlighted how indirect communication can de-escalate tensions and sustain engagement. These parallels suggest that confession narratives may function as informal sites of “narrative diplomacy,” where students negotiate meaning, critique institutional practices, and express frustrations through indirect yet impactful communication.

Despite these connections, the diplomatic dimension of confession pages remains underexplored. Existing studies have richly documented their psychological, social, and cultural functions (Tagaytay et al., 2014; Geonzon et al., 2014; Esteban & Cruz, 2021; Hnit & Almanna, 2025), but few have analyzed them as communicative systems with institutional significance. This gap underscores the need to move beyond viewing confession pages merely as outlets of self-expression and instead examine them as informal diplomatic signals that can inform institutional dialogue, negotiation, and conflict resolution. By situating confession narratives within this communicative framework, the present study seeks to contribute a new perspective that bridges student-level expression with institutional-level diplomacy.

Recognizing this dimension is crucial because it allows for a deeper analysis of confession pages beyond their functional or psychological utility. While many studies correctly examine the impact of social media on communication (Ngai et al., 2015; Khalili et al., 2024), few address the communicative layer in which confession pages operate as informal diplomatic systems. This research explores the CTU confession page as a site of indirect communication, focusing on the strategies, themes, and functions embedded in anonymous posts. By analyzing how anonymity influences disclosure and how narratives operate as informal channels of dialogue, the study seeks to provide insights into the broader implications of confession pages for academic communities and to propose a narrative-based diplomatic communication system.

Philosophical Stance

The study is grounded in the belief that anonymous digital narratives are not merely emotional outbursts but a specialized form of diplomatic communication. By using the Facebook CTU Confession Page, students navigate the power dynamics of Cebu Technological University, using anonymity as a "buffer" to voice concerns that might otherwise be silenced. These stories are interpreted as strategic actions where the author, audience awareness, and institutional context converge. The study uses four interrelated perspectives to understand how these narratives function as a grassroots communication system that balances personal expression with institutional critique.

Ontological Stance

Ontologically, this study adopts relativism, viewing reality as a socially constructed "negotiation" between the student and the institution. In the context of a "Diplomatic Communication System," each anonymous post represents a subjective truth that exists because traditional, direct communication channels may be perceived as closed or risky. Reality here is not a single objective truth about CTU but a plurality of lived experiences where students perform their identities and grievances through digital "diplomacy." This follows the idea that online self-disclosure is a way of constructing a social reality that allows for "safe" participation in the campus discourse (Levontin & Yom-Tov, 2017).

Epistemological Stance

Epistemologically, this study follows constructivism, asserting that knowledge is constructed through the interpretation of the anonymous confession posts. The researchers do not simply “find” meaning from the data; rather, they interpret how students use narrative strategies, emotional disclosure, anonymity, and indirect critique to communicate concerns with peers, administrators, and the wider CTU community. Knowledge is gained by examining recurring patterns, coded categories, and communicative markers that reveal how confession narratives function as informal signals of student experiences and institutional concerns. As Creswell (2014) suggests, this kind of knowledge is contextual and relies on the researcher's ability to connect individual narratives to broader meanings.

Axiological Stance

Axiologically, this study is value-laden, recognizing the ethical weight of handling "diplomatic" grievances. The researchers acknowledge that these narratives often stem from a place of vulnerability or perceived injustice. We approach the data with reflexive empathy, prioritizing the protection of the anonymous "diplomats" (the posters) while respecting the integrity of the institution being critiqued. This stance aligns with Berger's (2015) view that researcher values are inseparable from the work. Our commitment is to authenticity and ethical representation, ensuring that the emotional labor of the students is treated with professional respect and confidentiality.

Rhetorical Stance

Rhetorically, the study uses an interpretive-analytical and category-based style that reflects the nature of qualitative content analysis. Rather than presenting the findings through statistical testing, the study organizes the discussion according to the research questions and coding categories, including narrative structure, self-expression themes, depth of disclosure, anonymity function, and diplomatic communication markers. The language of the study emphasizes the communicative function of the posts through terms such as “narrative structure,” “emotional disclosure,” “institutional feedback,” “anonymity function,” and “diplomatic communication markers.” Selected anonymized excerpts and coded tables are used to provide evidentiary support while protecting the identity and dignity of the writers. This rhetorical approach allows the reader to understand the CTU Confession Page not merely as a social media space but as an informal communication system where student concerns are expressed, interpreted, and connected to possible institutional response.

Review of Related Literature

This section reviews literature on Facebook confession pages as platforms for storytelling and self-expression among Cebu Technological Students. It outlines thematic background, highlights research gaps, and presents the guiding theoretical framework. The discussion also clarifies the study’s variables and synthesizes scholarship to establish its foundation and rationale.

Emergent Theories

This study was built upon a triad of frameworks that explained the psychological drive, the digital medium, and the systemic impact of online confessions. This study was primarily anchored in **Digital Storytelling Theory** (Lambert, 2013) and **Self-Disclosure Theory** (Jourard, 1971), with **Narrative Paradigm Theory** (Fisher, 1987) serving as the critical bridge to understanding their implications for a diplomatic communication system.

At the psychological level, this study utilized Self-Disclosure Theory to clarify why individuals reveal personal matters in public spaces. Jourard (1971) claimed that disclosing oneself was a requirement for mental well-being, as it allowed individuals to release private thoughts and emotions. In the context of virtual worlds, the level of self-disclosure was found to be greatly influenced by anonymity and audience recognition (Ma et al., 2016; Levontin & Yom-Tov, 2017). Anonymity, in particular, diminished concerns about being judged, which facilitated the expression of more profound feelings (Bargh et al., 2002; Nguyen et al., 2021). Emotional disclosure, which is the act of writing out inner vulnerabilities, was regarded as a voluntary channel for students to process stressful or significant events (Smyth & Arigo, 2016). On the CTU Confession page, this act becomes a "cathartic release," where the perception of an emotionally safe, anonymous space encourages students to share intimate experiences and institutional criticisms they would otherwise withhold.

While self-disclosure explains motivation, Digital Storytelling Theory (Lambert, 2013) explains the method. It describes how individuals utilize digital tools to narrate their life stories through concise, multimodal narratives. These confession pages function as modern digital diaries where users do more than just share facts; they engage in "identity creation" and "social connection" (Hall, 2018; Robin, 2016). Bouchrika (2025) emphasizes that digital storytelling allows people to incorporate truthfulness and feeling into their accounts, transforming personal events into shared community experiences. Within the CTU Confessions ecosystem, technology changes the nature of the story, making what was once private a shared, participatory event (Ohler, 2013; Perone, 2014).

To bridge these personal stories with the broader "diplomatic communication system," this study incorporated Narrative Paradigm Theory (Fisher, 1987). Fisher posits that humans are homo narrans (storytellers) who evaluate communication through "narrative rationality," specifically narrative coherence (does the story hang together?) and narrative fidelity (does the story ring true to the listener’s experience?). In a diplomatic communication system, institutional authority often relies on formal logic, yet confession pages introduce a "narrative logic." When a student’s confession possesses high fidelity, it resonates with the collective student body, gaining the power to challenge or shape formal institutional discourse. These narratives are not merely isolated posts; they are influential communicative acts that demand a "diplomatic" response or interpretation from the institution.

By integrating these three theories, this research explored the relationship between digital platforms as narrative sites and the resulting patterns of emotional sharing. Self-disclosure provides the emotional spark, digital storytelling provides the narrative structure, and the narrative paradigm provides the logic through which these stories impact the university’s communication system. Together, these frameworks allowed a comprehensive analysis of how technology influences the communication of emotions, the construction of identity, and the diplomatic tensions between anonymous student voices and institutional responses.

Confession Page Narratives

Online confession pages were defined as popular digital spaces where users anonymously posted personal disclosures, emotions, and viewpoints. These user-generated platforms operated outside of official institutional guidelines, which allowed for a high degree of openness and perceived truthfulness. This unique environment enabled users to interpret their lives through shared vulnerability and mutual support (Voss et al., 2023; Belmonte et al., 2024). In this study, "narratives" represented the stories individuals used to construct meaning from their experiences. On these pages, storytelling was shaped by anonymity, the specific "vibe" or norms of the platform, and the perceived reactions of the audience, all of which influenced both the content and the delivery of the messages.

Confession Page Narratives served as the Independent Variable (IV) in this research. This term referred to the diverse types of stories and messages shared on anonymous school-related confession pages, illustrating how individuals communicated struggles, emotions, and social observations in a public yet mediated space. As communicative artifacts, these narratives functioned beyond simple information-sharing; they played vital social roles, including emotional release, validation-seeking, and institutional critique.

Confession page narratives were categorized into three distinct types that served as the analytical levels for the independent variable: (1) **emotional narratives,** which disclosed the writers' personal feelings such as stress, love, or frustration; (2) **adversarial or critical narratives**, which provided social commentary, voiced institutional grievances, or highlighted community issues within academia; and (3) **emotional journey narratives**, which depicted a progression or shift in emotional states and reflections across a single post (Gagalang et al., 2022; Lorenzana & Soriano, 2023). Distinguishing between these types was vital, as each reflected unique communicative intentions with different implications for how messages were interpreted within the digital system.

Diplomatic Communication System

The Dependent Variable (DV) in this study was the Diplomatic Communication System. This referred to a framework of prosocial interaction characterized by respect, empathy, conflict management, and constructive dialogue within a community. In academic discourse, diplomatic communication involves the strategic use of tact, honesty, and sensitivity, particularly when addressing disagreements or sensitive topics. In digital environments, diplomacy became increasingly critical because the absence of nonverbal cues, such as body language and tone, heightened the risk of message misinterpretation.

Scholars have argued that anonymous online sites can either degrade polite behavior or, conversely, foster more honest and respectful communication depending on the narrative structure used (Voss et al., 2023). In this study, the Diplomatic Communication System was examined through specific indicators, including the overall tone of the conversations, the level of empathy displayed in replies, the methods used to settle arguments, and the perceived fairness of page moderation. The study intended to reveal how different types of digital storytelling influenced the quality and effectiveness of diplomatic communication within an online academic community.

Existing literature suggests a strong correlation between anonymity, narrative expression, and communication behavior in online settings. Anonymous posts have been found to exhibit significantly higher emotional intensity and openness than non-anonymous ones, particularly regarding sensitive topics like mental health and personal identity (Conrad, 2014; Barari, 2015). This study proceeded from the perspective that anonymity rendered digital narratives not only more authentic but also thematically deeper.

The relationship between Facebook confession narratives and the Diplomatic Communication System was defined by how narrative features, shaped by anonymity, allowed for indirect, empathetic, and non-confrontational communication. It was expected that increased anonymity would influence indicators of narrative depth, such as emotional lexicon and reflective language, which in turn facilitated softened critique and de-escalatory discourse. Through this relationship, confession posts functioned as narrative-based communicative acts that allowed students to negotiate concerns and express tensions within the university context without the need for direct confrontation. Consequently, Facebook confession pages were treated as digital spaces where anonymity mediated both storytelling practices and informal diplomatic communication.

Related Empirical Studies

Confession Pages as Emotional Support and Informal Communication Channels

Facebook confession pages have been widely recognized as venues for emotional support and peer connection among students. During the COVID-19 pandemic, online interaction increased dramatically, and students relied on social networks to share concerns and maintain connections (Voss et al., 2023; Belmonte et al., 2024). Local studies in the Philippines found that confession pages acted as informal support systems where students managed academic stress, personal problems, and emotional issues while receiving empathy and validation from peers (Gagalang, 2022; Lorenzana & Soriano, 2021). These findings highlight the communicative value of confession pages as spaces where students indirectly signal their needs and concerns to the wider academic community, functioning as informal communication channels rather than simply social outlets.

Anonymity and Indirect Communication

Anonymity consistently emerges as a central factor shaping how students communicate through confession pages. Research shows that anonymity empowers students to control tone and emotional disclosure, enabling honesty while reducing fear of judgment or backlash (Rodriguez et al., 2023; Laor, 2025). Studies on online disclosure confirm that anonymity fosters intimacy and encourages deeper self-expression (Levontin & Yom-Tov, 2017; Ma et al., 2016; Nguyen et al., 2021). This indirectness is significant because it parallels diplomatic practices, where sensitive concerns are voiced through carefully chosen language to maintain dialogue and avoid direct confrontation (Melissen, 2013; Voss et al., 2023). Thus, anonymity does more than erase identity markers; it shapes the communicative framing of confession narratives, making indirect and reflective communication possible.

Narratives, Identity, and Collective Meaning-Making

Confession pages have also been studied as sites of narrative construction and collective meaning-making. Students often use story-like patterns in their posts to communicate personal growth, shared struggles, and aspirations (Motefalcon, 2023; Tagaytay et al., 2014). These narratives mirror university culture and collective values, revealing the emotional climate of academic communities (Geonzon et al., 2014). Broader studies on digital storytelling emphasize that online narratives contribute to identity creation, emotional resilience, and comprehension (Esteban & Cruz, 2021; Hnit & Almanna, 2025; Rubio-Hurtado et al., 2022). While these findings highlight the narrative dimension of confession pages, they also point to their broader communicative role: students use narratives not only to express themselves but also to indirectly engage with institutional structures.

Confession Pages and Institutional Dialogue

Beyond their role in emotional support and identity construction, confession pages also function as informal channels of communication between students and institutions. Sacks, Gressier, and Maldon (2021) emphasized that Facebook confession pages can serve as valuable data resources for academic and student support services, offering administrators insights into student concerns that may otherwise remain hidden. Similarly, Amador and Amador (2014) found that social media platforms, including confession pages, provide opportunities for students to seek help and indirectly communicate with academic advisors. Tagaytay et al. (2014) highlighted that confession pages reflect institutional culture, capturing the values, frustrations, and expectations of students in ways that formal surveys often miss. These studies suggest that confession pages are not only personal outlets but also institutional signals, offering administrators a chance to interpret student narratives as part of broader campus dialogue. However, the challenge remains in translating these anonymous disclosures into constructive institutional responses that go beyond monitoring and reactive measures.

Parallels with Diplomatic Communication

The communicative strategies found in confession narratives share similarities with diplomatic practices, particularly in the use of indirectness, negotiation, and conflict management. Melissen (2013) described diplomacy as a process of dialogue where language is carefully chosen to balance honesty with tact, a dynamic that resonates with how students frame their anonymous confessions. Voss et al. (2023) further noted that indirect communication often serves to de-escalate tensions, allowing dialogue to continue without confrontation. Broader studies on social media communication also highlight how online platforms shape indirect disclosure and negotiation of meaning (Ngai et al., 2015; Khalili et al., 2024). In this sense, confession pages can be understood as informal sites of “narrative diplomacy,” where students employ anonymity and storytelling to voice concerns, critique institutional practices, and negotiate their place within the academic community. This perspective expands the analysis of confession pages beyond psychological or literary dimensions, situating them within the broader field of communication and diplomacy.

Despite the growing body of work, most studies focus on the psychological and social functions of confession pages, such as emotional support, belongingness, and identity expression (Sacks et al., 2021; Abd Rahman, 2018). Few have examined their role as indirect communication systems that carry institutional significance. In particular, the parallels between confession narratives and diplomatic communications such as negotiation of meaning, indirect critique, and conflict management—remain underexplored. This gap underscores the need to analyze confession pages not only as outlets of self-expression but also as informal diplomatic signals that can inform institutional dialogue and decision-making.

Taken together, the reviewed studies establish that Facebook confession pages serve multiple roles: they provide emotional support and peer connection, enable anonymity that fosters indirect communication, and function as narrative spaces where identity and collective meaning are constructed. Beyond these student-centered functions, confession pages also act as institutional signals, offering administrators insights into campus culture and student concerns. Most importantly, the communicative strategies embedded in confession narratives parallel diplomatic practices of negotiation, indirect critique, and conflict management. Addressing the identified gap, the present study contributes by analyzing CTU confession narratives not only as outlets of self-expression but also as informal diplomatic signals, thereby proposing a narrative-based communication system that strengthens dialogue between students and institutions.

THE PROBLEM

Statement of the Problem

This study aimed to explore the CTU Confession page as a form of indirect communication, examining how Cebu Technological University (CTU) students used anonymity to share concerns, negotiate meaning, and express emotional experiences during the Second (2nd) Semester of A.Y. 2025–2026.

Specifically, this research sought to answer the following questions:

1. What are the dominant narrative structures present in the anonymous confession posts shared by CTU students?
2. What communicative themes of self-expression and emotional negotiation are prevalent in the anonymous confession narratives of CTU students?
3. How does the function of anonymity shape the nature and depth of emotional disclosure in these digital narratives?
4. What narrative-based diplomatic communication system can be proposed based on the findings?

Significance of the Study

The importance of this study lies in its recognition of the “unfiltered emotional world” of students, expressed through anonymous confession narratives, as a valuable source of informal diplomatic signals rather than simply a collection of individual complaints. By treating confession page narratives as forms of indirect communication, the research highlights how anonymity enables students to share concerns, negotiate meaning, and express emotional experiences in ways that parallel diplomatic practices of dialogue and conflict management. The ultimate outcome of this study is the establishment of a narrative-based diplomatic communication system that promotes understanding, de-escalates conflict, and strengthens the relationship between the university and its students.

This study benefits the following stakeholders:

CTU Students. The study validates and empowers students by treating their anonymous accounts as strategic communicative acts. Through the identification of narrative patterns and themes, students can better understand how their indirect communication contributes to collective dialogue and how anonymity allows them to negotiate their needs in a non-confrontational manner.

Office of Student Affairs (SAO). The findings provide the SAO with a diplomacy-oriented toolkit for institutional communication. Instead of limiting responses to monitoring or reactive measures, the office can use thematic clusters and emotional signals to craft more proactive and empathetic interventions that address student concerns.

Faculty and Academic Departments. Insights from the study help faculty recognize underlying communication patterns related to student stress and concerns. This enables them to adapt their engagement strategies, offering feedback and support that is more responsive to the indirect signals students communicate through confession narratives.

Guidance Counselors. Counselors can use the analysis of confession narratives to identify subtle or indirect expressions of distress. By understanding how anonymity shapes disclosure, they can refine outreach methods to better connect with students who may otherwise remain silent in traditional counseling settings.

University Administration. The institution benefits from the proposed Diplomatic Communication System, which transforms anonymous narratives into actionable institutional intelligence. This system allows administrators to engage in narrative-informed dialogue, reducing the risk of high-stakes conflict and fostering a more harmonious campus environment.

Future Researchers. This study contributes to the growing body of literature on digital communication by emphasizing confession pages as informal diplomatic channels. It lays the groundwork for further investigations into how anonymous online narratives can inform institutional communication, negotiation practices, and conflict resolution in academic settings.

METHODOLOGY

Reflexivity Statement

The researchers acknowledged their dual role as both members of the CTU community and analysts of its digital narratives. This positionality requires reflexivity to ensure that interpretations remain balanced and critically aware of institutional dynamics. A reflexive research log was maintained throughout the study to document decisions, biases, and evolving insights.

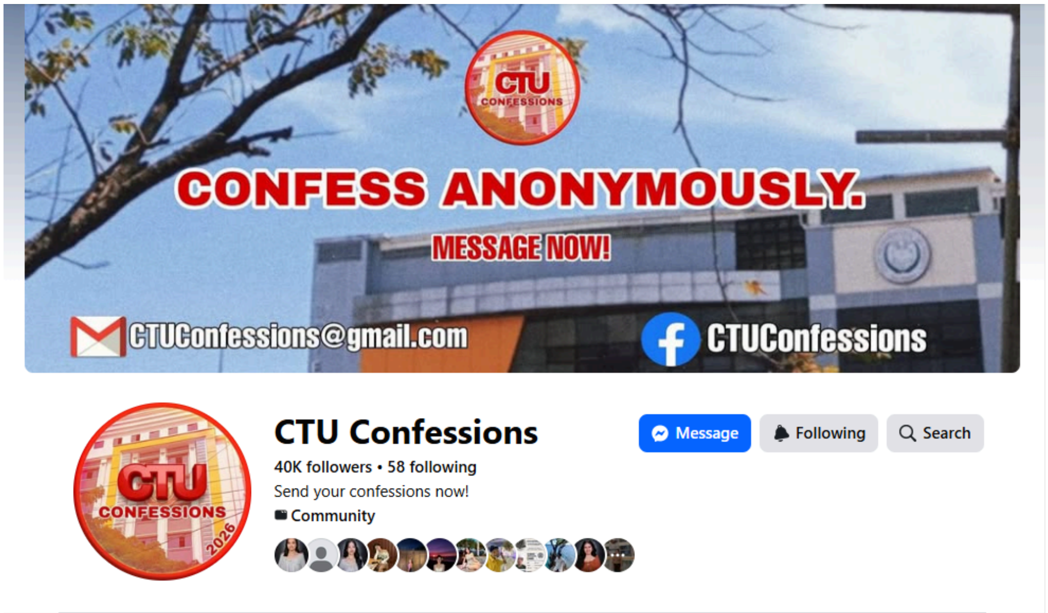
Design

This study employed a qualitative content analysis design to systematically examine confession posts from the CTU Confession Page. Content analysis was selected because it provides a rigorous yet flexible framework for interpreting textual data, allowing researchers to detect recurring patterns of meaning while remaining grounded in authentic participant voices (Krippendorff, 2018; Schreier, 2012).

Each individual confession post was treated as a single unit of analysis. All selected posts were read multiple times to establish familiarity with their content and context. Following this, the researchers applied inductive coding guided by the coding manual to identify recurring patterns related to narrative form, emotional expression, and communicative strategies. The resulting codes were subsequently grouped into broader thematic categories to capture shared meanings across posts. Finally, these themes were analyzed to examine how anonymity influences narrative construction, emotional disclosure, and identity expression within the student community. Through this process, confession posts were interpreted as both personal narratives and collective expressions of shared cultural practices (Creswell & Poth, 2018).

Environment

According to Admin Suu, the CTU Confession Page serves as a nexus platform for the entire CTU system, managed by a team of twelve administrators comprising both students and alumni. While founded by "Creator K," the platform's daily operations are currently maintained by six active moderators. As a mediated communicative space, the page provides students from various satellite and extension campuses with a venue to express lived experiences, academic frustrations, and communal concerns. It functions as an informal diplomatic interface where individual voices contribute to collective narratives, reflecting the evolving culture of the CTU student body.


CTU CONFESSIONS
CONFESS ANONYMOUSLY.
MESSAGE NOW!
CTUConfessions@gmail.com
CTUConfessions
CTU CONFESSIONS 2026
Message
Following
Search

CTU Confessions

40K followers • 58 following

Send your confessions now!

Community

Figure 1: CTU Confession Page

Source: https://www.facebook.com/share/1AfNpcdPAA/

CTU CONFESSION
ADMIN'S TEAM
Creator
K
Admin
Loki
Admin
Icarus
Admin
Sinotchi
Admin
Mah
Admin
Aizen
Admin
Lee
Admin
Q
Admin
Naksu ya
Admin
jaxxythalia
Admin
Suu
Admin
yuan
Admin
Gab
CTU Confession
ctuconfessions92@gmail.com

Figure 2: CTU Confession Admin's Team

Source: https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1Avgkz82es/

Data Source and Sampling

The primary data source consisted of anonymous, text-based confession posts archived on the CTU Confession Page. A purposive sampling strategy was employed to ensure that selected posts met the study's inclusion and exclusion criteria. The study included posts that contained at least 100 words to ensure sufficient narrative depth and detail. Only original text-based content reflecting personal experiences or campus-related concerns was considered for analysis. On the other hand, posts containing identifiable names or personal information were excluded to protect privacy and confidentiality. Entries that consisted only of shared content or images were also excluded, as well as brief non-narrative updates that lacked reflective or descriptive substance.

The scope of the study was limited to confession posts published during the second academic semester (A.Y. 2025–2026). From an initial pool of approximately 100 posts, the inclusion and exclusion criteria were first applied to filter the dataset. From the remaining posts, 15 were then selected based on narrative richness, thematic relevance, and communicative depth. The final sample size was determined through the principle of theoretical saturation, wherein data collection and analysis ceased once no new themes or narrative strategies emerged (Hennink et al., 2017; Saunders et al., 2018).

Instrument

The primary instrument was a content analysis coding manual, which served as the basis for analyzing confession posts. The manual defined categories for narrative forms, thematic content, emotional disclosure, and communicative framing, as well as indicators of narrative-based diplomatic communication including empathic framing, reflective positioning, softened critique, and indirect expression of sensitive issues (Cohen, 2012; Melissen, 2013). The coding manual was applied to each selected post during analysis, with coders adhering strictly to the predefined categories and definitions to ensure consistency. Through this standardized procedure, researcher bias was minimized and analytic rigor was enhanced (Williams, 2023). The resulting coded data formed the basis for interpreting confession narratives as communicative acts that depict informal diplomatic practices in digital environments (Wang, 2025).

Data Analysis

To ensure consistency and reliability in the coding process, the study applied a set of analytical rules where posts containing multiple concerns were coded under all relevant themes with a designated primary category, while depth of disclosure was determined based on emotional intensity, distinguishing deep disclosure for highly emotional expressions from surface-level disclosure for routine concerns, anonymity was identified either explicitly or implicitly depending on the sensitivity of the content, inter-rater reliability was maintained through strict adherence to the coding manual with disagreements resolved through discussion, and flexibility was ensured by assigning non-fitting data to an “Other” category with detailed notes to capture emerging patterns.

Data Gathering Procedures

The data-gathering process was conducted in three phases, beginning with the pre-collection phase where ethical clearance was obtained from university authorities, consent was secured from page administrators after explaining the study’s purpose and safeguards, and inclusion and exclusion criteria were finalized alongside the establishment of anonymization protocols, followed by the collection phase where confession posts were systematically gathered, identifying information such as names, courses, and locations was masked or replaced with pseudonyms, the anonymized dataset was compiled and verified through double-checking of metadata accuracy, and a reflexive research log was maintained to document analytic decisions, and finally the post-collection phase where the dataset was reviewed for completeness and anonymity, securely stored with restricted access to authorized researchers, selected excerpts were paraphrased when necessary to prevent re-identification, and the cleaned corpus was subjected to systematic coding and interpretation based on the established analytical framework.

Ethical Considerations

Ethical safeguards were guided by the **Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173)** and contextual consent principles. While the confession page is publicly accessible, the researchers recognized that contributors may not expect their posts to be used for academic research. This distinction between public visibility and user expectations raises critical issues of privacy and consent (Robinson et al., 2021).

To address these concerns, the study implemented strict measures, namely, **(a)** the deletion or modification of recognizable information, **(b)** sensitive disclosures were paraphrased to prevent harm, and **(c)** ensuring that all collected digital data were securely stored and handled (Kizilcec et al., 2020; Bell & Vinsen, 2022; Vines et al., 2019).

Beyond legal compliance, the researchers upheld the moral responsibility to protect participants from harm and to maintain transparency throughout the research process. By prioritizing anonymity, openness, and ethical rigor, the study sought to honor the trust and vulnerability embedded in student confessions.

DEFINITION OF TERMS

The following terms are defined based on their specific use and meaning within this study to ensure clear understanding.

A Facebook confession post is an anonymous message submitted by a user to a specific Facebook “confession page,” where it is then published by a page administrator for a wider community to read and discuss.

Anonymity is the quality or condition of remaining unknown or unidentified by most other people. It is a situation in which someone’s name is not given or known.

Depth of Disclosure refers to the extent or level of which a confession narrative reveals personal information, emotional vulnerability, experiences, and circumstances of the student.

Diplomatic refers to polite, carefully worded responses designed to avoid offense, conflict, or hurting feelings, often by being vague, polite, or focusing on solutions rather than blaming, especially in sensitive situations.

Emotional Negotiation refers to the way students organize, transform, and communicate their emotions into purposeful forms of communication such as critique, confession, justification, identity defense, or appeals for understanding.

Facebook Confession Page is an anonymous online forum, often tied to schools or communities, where users submit secrets, thoughts, crushes, or complaints to an admin who posts them publicly. It allows people to share freely without revealing their identity, acting like a digital “freedom wall” for venting, gossip, and sometimes even serious issues, though they can also breed negativity like cyberbullying and rumors.

Narrative refers to a story or account of events, real or imagined, presented in a structured way (beginning, middle, and end) to convey meaning, perspective, and connections between events, characters, and themes, existing in forms like books, films, songs, or even personal conversation.

The Diplomatic Communication System, in this study, refers to the CTU Confession Page acting as a mediated platform where administrators serve as "diplomatic agents." It is the operational process of gathering, moderating, and presenting raw student expressions, such as rants, grievances, and commendations, to the public. This system functions as an informal bridge that translates individual student "voices" into a collective discourse reflecting the needs and climate of the CTU campuses.

Chapter 2

PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS, AND INTERPRETATION

This chapter presents the results and discussion of the qualitative content analysis conducted on fifteen selected anonymous confession posts from the CTU Confession Page. Following the qualitative content analysis design, each post was treated as one unit of analysis and was read several times to understand its content, context, emotional tone, and communicative purpose. The researchers applied the coding manual to identify patterns related to narrative structure, self-expression, depth of disclosure, anonymity, and diplomatic communication.

Narrative Structures: Telling Their Stories from the Sidelines

In analyzing the fifteen (15) selected posts according to plot or arc, narrative form, and narrative style, dominant structures emerged, namely: Emotional Journey, Adversarial, and Confessional plots, which were commonly expressed through Reflective, Chronological, Dialogic, or Fragmented forms. In terms of style, all selected posts used emotionally charged language, while several also used literary devices such as metaphor, repetition, contrast, and direct address. These patterns show that the confession posts were not random online statements; rather, they were organized narratives through which students arranged experiences into meaningful accounts of struggle, reflection, criticism, and appeal.

Table 1

Narrative Structure Codes of the Selected Confession Posts

Code Group	Specific Group	Frequency (N=15)	Interpretation
Plot/Arc	Emotional Journey	66.67%	Posts often moved from experience to emotion, critique, or personal disclosure.
	Adversarial	60%	
	Confessional	53.33%	
Narrative Form	Reflective	93.33%	Students explained, sequenced, addressed, or emotionally released their concerns.
	Chronological	33.33%	
	Dialogic	26.67%	
	Fragmented	20%	
Narrative Style	Emotionally Charged Language	100%	Posts used strong emotional language and expressive style to make meaning persuasive.
	Literary Devices	53.33%	

As shown in Table 1, the Emotional Journey code appeared strongly in posts where students moved from distress, frustration, or confusion toward reflection, realization, or encouragement. For example, Post 2 included the statement, *"You are not weak for struggling,"* which shows a movement from emotional struggle toward affirmation. Posts 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 11, 12, and 13 also followed a similar movement because the writers did not merely describe a problem; they explained how the experience affected them and how they made sense of it. This finding supports recent studies on digital storytelling which argue that online narratives are not only expressions of personal experience but also acts of identity construction and meaning-making (Rubio-Hurtado et al., 2022; Hnit & Almanna, 2025).

The Adversarial code appeared in posts that expressed dissatisfaction, disagreement, or criticism toward policies, institutional processes, authority figures, or social behavior. However, the adversarial character of these posts did not necessarily make them aggressive. Many of the writers used reasoning, explanation, and appealed to justify their criticism. For instance, Post 1 stated*, "We just want to ask for some thought,"* showing that the writer framed the concern as a request for reconsideration rather than a direct attack. This pattern strengthens the idea that confession pages can operate as indirect communication channels where students raise concerns that may be difficult to express through formal mechanisms (Sacks et al., 2021; Laor, 2025).

The Confessional code was identified in posts that revealed private feelings, sensitive experiences, or personal struggles. Post 6 stated, *"I just want to vent out what I've been feeling,"* while Post 7 expressed the fear of being emotionally unseen. These examples show how anonymous confession narratives often carry intimate concerns that go beyond simple public commentary. Recent research on social media self-disclosure explains that users tend to disclose deeper or more personal content when the platform gives them a sense of psychological distance, audience protection, or identity shielding (Nguyen et al., 2021; Zani et al., 2025).

In terms of narrative form, Reflective was the most common because students frequently evaluated their experiences and explained what these experiences meant to them. Chronological Form appeared when students narrated problems step-by-step, making their stories easier to follow and more persuasive. Dialogic Form appeared in posts that directly addressed an individual, group, or institution, while Fragmented Form appeared in emotionally intense posts where the writer's thoughts were expressed in broken or scattered sequences. These forms demonstrate that the students' digital narratives carried both personal and social meaning. They also reflect the broader role of social media as a communicative space where emotions, identity, and public concerns are negotiated through narrative form (Khalili et al., 2024; Zhu, 2025).

Overall, the first finding shows that the dominant narrative structure of the selected confession posts was an emotional-reflective narrative shaped by personal disclosure, social critique, and appeal. Students used storytelling to make their concerns understandable, credible, and emotionally persuasive. This confirms that confession page narratives may be interpreted as communicative artifacts, not merely casual posts, because they contain recognizable patterns of narrative construction, emotional movement, and audience-directed meaning.

Self-Expression and Emotional Negotiation: Carrying Emotional Weight and Finding Words for It

The posts were coded according to the major themes of self-expression and the depth of emotional disclosure in which the findings showed that the most prevalent themes were Academic Stress, Mental Health, Social or Institutional Commentary, and Identity Exploration. The posts were also classified according to Moderate or Deep Level Disclosure. No post was coded as purely surface-level because all selected narratives contained reflective, emotional, or personal meaningful content.

Table 2

Self-Expression Themes and Depth of Disclosure

Theme/Category	**Frequency (N= 15)**	**Meaning**
Social or Institutional Commentary	73.33%	Students raised concerns about fairness, student treatment, leadership, process, or community behavior
Academic Stress	53.33%	Students connected school requirements with pressure, fear, and difficulty.
Identity Exploration	46.67%	Students used posts to question, defend, or affirm identity and belonging.
Mental Health	33.33%	Posts expressed anxiety, loneliness, emotional exhaustion, or distress.
Depth of Disclosure	53.33%	All selected posts had meaningful emotional or reflective content; no post was purely surface-level.
	46.67%	

As shown in Table 2, Academic Stress appeared in posts that described pressure, confusion, or difficulty related to school responsibilities. Post 4, for example, stated, *"I really want to cry because I'm afraid I might have to repeat the subject."* This line reveals how academic concerns are not experienced only as school requirements but also as emotional burdens that can affect confidence, mental well-being, and family expectations. In Post 13, the academic issue was connected to financial burden through the phrase *"₱3,000 taken away from our family budget,"* showing that school-related stress can intersect with economic pressure. Recent studies on Filipino students and digital media show that social media often becomes a space where learners communicate academic challenges and emotional needs when direct institutional communication feels limited or difficult (Lorenzana & Soriano, 2021; Belmonte et al., 2024).

Mental Health emerged as one of the strongest themes because several posts expressed anxiety, exhaustion, sadness, loneliness, or emotional breakdown. Post 2 stated, *"panic attacks are not 'just in your head,'"* while Post 7 expressed, *"I'm tired of being alone in this feeling."* These statements reveal that some confession posts functioned as indirect help-seeking or emotional release. The posts show that students used anonymity to translate private distress into public but protected expression. This supports recent findings that distress disclosure on social media can reflect emotional vulnerability, help-seeking tendencies, and the need for validation or social recognition, especially among young people and students (Ye & Gao, 2025; Laor, 2025).

Social or Institutional Commentary appeared in posts that raised concerns about school processes, leadership behavior, privacy, fairness, fees, or student treatment. Although some posts were critical, many writers framed their criticism through explanation and appeal. This means that the confession page did not only serve as a venue for venting; it also functioned as a public record of student perceptions. Similarly, Sacks et al. (2021) found that confession pages can serve as valuable data resources for academic and student support services because they reveal concerns that may not appear in formal surveys or consultations. In the present study, the presence of institutional commentary suggests that the CTU Confession Page may carry informal signals that offices and administrators can interpret for student-centered responses.

Identity Exploration was also evident in posts where students questioned, defended, or affirmed who they were. Post 6 asked, *“when will I have the freedom to love without hiding,”* while Post 15 stated, *“we have chosen our path, and we are proud of it.”* These examples show how confession posts allow students to speak about identity, belonging, recognition, and self-defense. Such findings align with recent studies that view digital narratives as spaces for constructing personal and social identity, especially when individuals negotiate acceptance, vulnerability, and community response (Rubio-Hurtado et al., 2022; Hnit & Almanna, 2025).

The distinction between Moderate and Deep Level Disclosure is important because it shows how emotional intensity shaped the meaning of the posts. Moderate disclosure appeared in posts where students presented meaningful concerns in a controlled tone, such as requesting fairness, clarity, or accountability. Deep disclosure appeared in posts that involved emotional pain, fear, isolation, or highly personal experiences. This pattern indicates that the confession page became a layered space for emotional negotiation: some students used it to communicate practical concerns, while others used it to reveal deeper emotional realities. Recent research on anonymous online platforms supports this interpretation by showing that anonymity can intensify disclosure and allow users to communicate sensitive experiences with less fear of direct judgment (Nguyen et al., 2021; Rodriguez et al., 2023; Laor, 2025).

Overall, the second finding shows that self-expression in the confession posts was not limited to complaint or emotional release. Instead, the posts combined academic, emotional, institutional, and identity-related concerns. Through these themes, students negotiated meaning by explaining their struggles, seeking recognition, defending their experiences, and asking for understanding. This strengthens the study’s claim that confession narratives function as student voices that carry both personal and institutional relevance.

Anonymity as a Condition for Emotional Disclosure

The findings showed that anonymity functioned in three major ways: as direct identity protection, as a condition that enabled risk-taking narratives, and as a factor that increased emotional depth. In this study, anonymity was not treated simply as the absence of a name; it was interpreted as a communicative condition that allowed students to express sensitive experiences with reduced fear of exposure, judgment, or retaliation.

Table 3

Anonymity Function Codes

Anonymity Function	Frequency (N=15)	Explanation
Explicit References to Anonymity	13.33%	Some writers directly requested to remain unidentified before revealing sensitive content.
Risk-taking Narratives	66.67%	Anonymity enabled students to discuss sensitive academic, social, or institutional concerns.
Emotional Depth	66.67%	Hidden identity allowed students to express fear, loneliness, frustration, and personal pain more openly.

As shown in Table 3, explicit references to anonymity appeared when writers directly asked to remain unidentified. Post 6 stated, “I would like to stay anonymous,” while Post 7 requested, “please hide my identity.” These statements show that anonymity was not incidental; it was actively requested by students before revealing sensitive content. This finding supports Laor (2025), who explains that confession pages rely heavily on anonymity because users perceive them as safer spaces for expression. It also aligns with Rodriguez et al. (2023), who found that university confession page posts are shaped by the protective function of anonymity and the user’s awareness of audience response.

Risk-taking narratives were identified in posts that involved sensitive academic, social, or institutional concerns. For example, Post 11 stated, “I will definitely fail most of my subjects,” while Post 3 referred to concerns about confidential feedback. These statements could expose the writer to embarrassment, conflict, or possible institutional consequences if the identity were known. Because the posts were anonymous, the writers were able to communicate issues that may have remained silent in face-to-face settings. Recent studies similarly suggest that anonymity can create a safer channel for users to disclose criticism, dissatisfaction, or vulnerability, although it also requires ethical moderation to prevent misuse or harm (Zani et al., 2025; Zhu, 2025).

Emotional Depth appeared strongly in posts where students revealed fear, loneliness, emotional exhaustion, unresolved pain, or distress. Post 7 stated, “I’m starting to wonder if I’m even worth it,” while Post 12 expressed, “I still hold a grudge against you.” These statements demonstrate that anonymity allowed the writers to express feelings that were deeply personal and emotionally risky. In this sense, anonymity shaped not only what students disclosed but also how deeply they disclosed it. Nguyen et al. (2021) explain that online self-disclosure is influenced by users’ perception of privacy, intimacy, and relational safety, while Ye and Gao (2025) show that distress disclosure on social media can reveal underlying emotional burdens among college students.

The findings further show that anonymity produced a paradox. On one hand, it protected students and encouraged honest sharing. On the other hand, it required careful ethical handling because anonymous disclosures may include sensitive mental health issues, criticism of individuals, or concerns that could affect institutional relationships. This is why the study's ethical procedures, such as masking identifiable details and paraphrasing sensitive excerpts, when necessary, remain essential. Recent literature on digital disclosure and online etiquette emphasizes that anonymous expression must be interpreted with both empathy and responsibility, especially when disclosures involve vulnerability or possible harm (Robinson et al., 2021; Zani et al., 2025).

Overall, the third finding shows that anonymity shaped the confession posts by making emotional and institutional disclosure more possible. Students used anonymity not only to hide identity but also to create enough safety to narrate fear, frustration, criticism, loneliness, and identity concerns. Therefore, anonymity functioned as a protective communicative layer that made deeper disclosure and indirect institutional communication possible.

Diplomatic Communication Markers in the Confession Posts

The selected posts were coded for diplomatic communication markers that could serve as the basis for the proposed Narrative Diplomatic Communication System. These markers included Softened Critique, Empathic Framing, Reflective Positioning, De-escalatory Language, and Respectful Tone. The presence of these codes shows that many students did not simply express anger or frustration; they often communicated concerns through careful wording, explanation, emotional restraint, and appeals for fairness.

Table 4

Diplomatic Communication Codes

Markers	Frequency (N=15)	Meaning
Softened Critique	80%	Concerns were raised without openly hostile language.
Empathic Framing	66.67%	Writers recognize others' situations or appeal for mutual understanding.
Reflective Positioning	100%	Students showed reasoning, self-awareness, and fair explanation.
De-escalatory Language	86.67%	Many posts remained polite despite sensitive or critical content.
Respectful Tone	60%	Some posts discouraged conflict and invited constructive responses.

As shown in Table 4, Softened Critique appeared when students raised concerns without using openly hostile or attacking language. Post 3 stated that the concern was raised *“not for attention nor to humiliate,”* while Post 1 stated*, “We just want to ask for some thought.”* These statements show that the writers attempted to balance criticism with careful explanation. This finding supports the study’s claim that confession posts can resemble informal diplomatic communication because students often soften their criticism to reduce direct confrontation. Voss et al. (2023) and Khalili et al. (2024) similarly emphasize that mediated communication can shape how people manage disagreement, negotiate meaning, and sustain interaction in digital spaces.

Empathic Framing appeared when students recognized the feelings, workload, or circumstances of others. Post 8 stated, *“we understand that he/she also has responsibilities,”* while Post 9 reminded readers that *“behind each class are real students.”* These statements demonstrate that the writers were not only defending themselves; they were also asking for mutual understanding. This code is important because empathy transforms a confession post from a one-sided complaint into a dialogic appeal. Recent studies on social media and student communication likewise suggest that digital platforms can become spaces where users seek validation, understanding, and collective support (Belmonte et al., 2024; Sacks et al., 2021).

Reflective Positioning was present when writers showed self-awareness, reasoning, or fair evaluation. Post 4 stated, *“I did everything as a student,”* while Post 8 reflected that *“Empathy should go both ways.”* These lines show that students position themselves as individuals trying to explain their side while still recognizing a broader context. This supports the interpretation that the confession posts were narrative-based communicative acts. In relation to Narrative Paradigm Theory, such reflective positioning strengthens narrative coherence because the post does not merely present emotion; it also provides reasons that make the story understandable and believable to readers.

De-escalatory Language appeared when writers attempted to reduce conflict, discourage hostility, or invite a more constructive response. Post 8 asked*, “why add more unnecessary conflict,”* while Post 9 encouraged *“supporting each other rather than tearing each other down.”* These statements show that some students used confession posts not only to express disagreement but also to call for calmer interaction. This finding is significant because it links anonymous expression to conflict management. When students frame concerns with de-escalatory language, confession posts become potential starting points for institutional listening rather than sources of uncontrolled conflict.

Respectful tone was also visible in posts that maintained politeness despite emotional or critical content. Post 4 ended with *“Respectfully, From sender*,” while Post 5 concluded with *“Thank you admin!”* These examples suggest that anonymity did not automatically produce disrespect. Instead, some writers used anonymity to communicate difficult concerns while still maintaining a polite tone. This finding is consistent with recent discussions on online etiquette and protection behavior, which argue that digital anonymity can support expression when paired with ethical and respectful communication practices (Zani et al., 2025; Laor, 2025).

Overall, the fourth finding shows that the confession posts contained several markers of diplomatic communication. Students used softened critique, empathy, reflection, de-escalation, and respect to express concerns in ways that could be heard by peers, faculty, administrators, or the wider CTU community. These patterns support the study’s central claim that confession page narratives can function as informal diplomatic signals. They reveal student concerns while also showing how students attempt to manage sensitivity, conflict, and audience response through language.

Chapter 3

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter summarizes the findings derived from the analyzed data of the study, presents the conclusions, and offers recommendations based on the results obtained.

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

The dominant narrative structures found in the fifteen selected CTU Confession Page posts were Emotional Journey, Adversarial, and Confessional plots. These were commonly expressed through reflective, chronological, dialogic, and emotionally charged forms. This shows that the posts were not merely random online statements but organized narratives that moved from experience to emotion, reflection, and appeal.

The major communicative themes of self-expression and emotional negotiation were Academic Stress, Mental Health, Social or Institutional Commentary, and Identity Exploration. The posts revealed that students used anonymous narratives to express school-related pressure, emotional distress, concerns about institutional processes, and questions of identity and belonging.

The depth of emotional disclosure was mostly moderate to deep. Moderate disclosure appeared in posts that raised concerns in a controlled and explanatory tone, while deep disclosure appeared in posts involving fear, loneliness, exhaustion, emotional pain, or highly personal concerns. This finding suggests that confession posts served as spaces where students could release emotions and seek recognition from the wider community.

Anonymity shaped nature and depth of disclosure by protecting identity, enabling risk-taking narratives, and increasing emotional openness. Students were able to discuss sensitive academic, emotional, social, and institutional matters more freely because anonymity reduced the fear of judgment, embarrassment, or possible consequences.

The posts demonstrated several diplomatic communication markers, including softened critique, empathic framing, reflective positioning, de-escalatory language, and respectful tone. These markers indicate that even when students expressed criticism or frustration, many of them attempted to communicate their concerns carefully, indirectly, and constructively.

Based on the findings, the proposed Narrative Diplomatic Communication System was developed as a supplementary framework for receiving, interpreting, responding to, and reviewing recurring anonymous student concerns. The system emphasizes ethical listening, privacy protection, pattern recognition, non-punitive response, and institutional learning.

CONCLUSION

Based on the findings of this study, several significant conclusions are drawn regarding the communicative dynamics of the CTU Confession Page. First, it is concluded that the platform functions as a vital digital space for indirect student communication, where personal experiences, emotional struggles, and institutional concerns are transformed into informal signals of campus realities. The narrative structures of the posts demonstrate that students do not merely utilize the platform for aimless venting; rather, they deliberately construct stories to explain their experiences, justify their emotions, and invite understanding. Therefore, these confession posts must be recognized as narrative artifacts that hold distinct social and communicative value within the university ecosystem. Furthermore, the recurring themes of academic stress, mental health, institutional commentary, and identity exploration reveal that student concerns are deeply interconnected, illustrating that academic pressures are inherently tied to emotional well-being, social belonging, and perceptions of institutional fairness.

Second, the study concludes that while anonymity serves as a protective communicative condition that empowers students to disclose sensitive concerns and engage in indirect critique, it simultaneously demands a heightened level of ethical responsibility. Because these anonymous narratives often contain vulnerable disclosures and institutional criticisms, they require careful handling by researchers and university authorities alike. Despite the lack of formal identifiers, the prevalent use of diplomatic communication markers—such as softened critique, empathy, reflection, de-escalation, and a respectful tone—supports the central claim of this study: that confession page narratives effectively function as informal diplomatic signals. Through these markers, students consciously shape their grievances to foster potential dialogue rather than incite direct confrontation.

Finally, this study concludes that the implementation of the proposed Narrative Diplomatic Communication System can significantly enhance how the university detects and addresses recurring student issues. By adopting this system, administration and student services can respond to the student body in a more ethical, empathetic, and student-centered manner. Ultimately, this framework is not intended to replace formal grievance procedures, guidance services, or official administrative channels; instead, it is concluded to be a valuable, supplementary mechanism that bridges the gap between informal student discourse and formal institutional responsiveness.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings, the following recommendations are offered:

For the **Office of Student Affairs**, it is recommended that the Narrative Diplomatic Communication System be considered as a supplementary student voice mechanism. The SAO may track recurring themes from anonymous confession posts without identifying writers and may use these patterns to design proactive student support responses.

For **Guidance Counselors**, posts coded as Deep Level Disclosure, Mental Health, and Emotional Depth should be treated as possible indirect help-seeking. Counselors may use recurring emotional patterns from confession narratives to strengthen awareness campaigns, online reminders, and accessible counseling invitations.

For **Faculty and Academic Departments**, the findings suggest the need for clearer and more empathic communication with students. Departments may respond to recurring academic concerns by improving advisory systems, clarifying requirements and procedures, and encouraging respectful feedback channels.

For the **University Administration**, recurring concerns about fees, enrollment processes, student welfare, leadership behavior, and institutional policies should be read as possible indicators of communication gaps. The administration may develop anonymous but ethical feedback mechanisms that allow students to raise concerns safely while still promoting accountability and verification.

For the **CTU Confession Page administrators and moderators**, it is recommended that moderation practices continue to protect anonymity while also preventing harm, misinformation, harassment, or direct identification. Moderators should balance student expression with ethical responsibility, especially when posts involve sensitive emotional or institutional concerns.

For **Future Researchers**, it is recommended that the coding manual be applied to a larger dataset across different CTU campuses and semesters. Future studies may also compare confession posts with formal student feedback mechanisms and may examine public comments on confession posts to understand how the wider student community responds to anonymous narratives.

Chapter 4

OUTPUT: THE NARRATIVE DIPLOMATIC COMMUNICATION SYSTEM

Rationale

The proposed Narrative Diplomatic Communication System is grounded on the findings that anonymous confession posts functioned not only as personal expressions but also as indirect signals of student concerns, emotional struggles, academic pressure, identity negotiation, and institutional feedback. Recent studies support the view that anonymous digital spaces can encourage students to disclose sensitive concerns more openly because anonymity reduces fear of judgment, exposure, and possible backlash (Nguyen et al., 2021; Rodriguez et al., 2023; Laor, 2025). In this study, the confession posts revealed recurring patterns that may not always appear in formal consultations, surveys, or classroom discussions.

The system is therefore proposed as a supplementary mechanism for ethical listening and narrative-informed institutional response. It does not replace official grievance procedures, guidance services, or administrative reporting channels. Instead, it provides a structured way of reading recurring anonymous narratives as possible indicators of student welfare and communication gaps. This is consistent with recent scholarship showing that confession pages and online student communities can serve as informal sources of student support data, campus climate insight, and communication feedback (Sacks et al., 2021; Belmonte et al., 2024; Khalili et al., 2024).

Through this system, the university may respond to concerns in a non-punitive, non-identifying, and student-centered manner.

The rationale of the proposed output also rests on the diplomatic markers found in the posts, such as softened critique, empathic framing, reflective positioning, de-escalatory language, and respectful tone. These markers suggest that many students were not simply attacking individuals or institutions; rather, they were attempting to express concerns while maintaining distance, safety, and indirect dialogue. Recent discussions on online communication and conflict management emphasize that indirect and carefully framed communication can help reduce confrontation and sustain dialogue when issues are sensitive (Voss et al., 2023; Laor, 2025). Thus, the proposed system transforms anonymous confession narratives into a responsible process of reception, interpretation, response, and review.

Objectives

The proposed Narrative Diplomatic Communication System aims to:

1. provide an ethical process for receiving and organizing anonymized confession posts as supplementary student feedback;
2. classify recurring concerns according to narrative structure, self-expression theme, depth of disclosure, anonymity function, and diplomatic communication markers;
3. guide appropriate, non-punitive, and student-centered institutional responses to academic, emotional, social, and policy-related concerns;
4. strengthen indirect dialogue between students and university offices while protecting privacy, dignity, and anonymity; and

5. establish a sustainable basis for semester-based review of recurring student concerns and institutional communication needs.

Scheme Of Implementation

The scheme of implementation presents how the proposed system may be operationalized by identifying the major phases, key activities, responsible units, and expected outputs. The process begins with ethical reception of anonymous narratives, followed by interpretation through the coding manual, response through appropriate university offices, and review through semester-based evaluation.

Table 5
Scheme of Implementation for the Narrative Diplomatic Communication System

Phase/Time Frame	Key Activities	Responsible Units	Expected Output
Phase 1: Reception and Ethical Screening	Ethically observe relevant confession posts; mask names and any identifying details; log recurring concerns by category.	CTU Confession Page moderators; SAO; trained student volunteers or researchers.	Anonymized narrative log
Phase 2: Interpretation and Coding Monthly	Code posts by narrative structure, theme, disclosure depth, anonymity function, and diplomatic markers; note urgent patterns.	SAO; Guidance Office	Monthly thematic summary or narrative brief.

Phase 3: Response and Support Action as Needed	Prepare non-identifying responses such as advisories, guidance reminders, policy clarifications, support campaigns, or consultations.	SAO; Guidance Office; faculty and student representatives	Student-centered response plan or support action
Phase 4: Review and Feedback Loop End of Semester	Evaluate recurring concerns and responses; compare with formal feedback channels, recommend communication and policy improvements.	Administration; SAO; Guidance Office; faculty and student representatives	Semester narrative communication report

In this implementation scheme, the confession posts are treated with caution and responsibility. The system emphasizes patterns rather than personality, support rather than punishment, and institutional learning rather than surveillance. By following this structure, the university can use anonymous narratives as supplementary communication signals while still respecting privacy, ethical safeguards, and the limitations of online confession data.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Abd Rahman, N. F. B. (2018). *A Conversation Analysis of Facebook Confessions Pages: Identity and Identification* (Doctoral dissertation, University of York).

Ahmed, S. K. (2024). The pillars of trustworthiness in qualitative research. *Journal of Medicine, Surgery, and Public Health*, *2*, 100051. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.glmedi.2024.100051

Amador, P., & Amador, J. (2014). Academic advising via Facebook: Examining student help seeking. *The Internet and Higher Education*, *21*, 9-16. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.iheduc.2013.10.003

Baikie, K. A., & Wilhelm, K. (2005). Emotional and physical health benefits of expressive writing. *Advances in Psychiatric Treatment*, *11*(5), 338–346. https://doi.org/10.1192/apt.11.5.338

Bargh, J. A., McKenna, K. Y. A., & Fitzsimons, G. M. (2002). Can you see the real me? Activation and expression of the “true self” on the Internet. Journal of Social Issues, 58(1), 33–48. https://doi.org/10.1111/1540-4560.00247

Belmonte, Z. J. A., Prasetyo, Y. T., Cahigas, M. M., Young, M. N., Nadlifatin, R., & Decapia, R. F. (2024, August). Exploring the impact of social media usage on Filipino students’ learning outcomes during the COVID-19 pandemic. In Proceedings of the 2024 8th International Conference on Digital Technology in Education (ICDTE) (pp. 47-55). https://doi.org/10.1145/3696230.3696249

Berger, R. (2013). Now I see it, now I don’t: researcher’s position and reflexivity in qualitative research. *Qualitative Research*, *15*(2), 219-234. https://doi.org/10.1177/1468794112468475 (Original work published 2015)

Bouchrika, I. (2025). *Digital Storytelling: Benefits, Examples, Tools & Tips*. Research.com.

Creswell, J. W. (2014). Research designs. Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches. https://doi.org/10.5539/ELT.V12N5P40

Esteban Jr, A. M., & Cruz, M. J. P. (2021). Digital divide in times of pandemic among teacher education students. Open Access Library Journal, 8(4), 1-12.

Faja, S. (2013). Collaborative Learning in Online Courses: Exploring Students' Perceptions. *Information Systems Education Journal*, *11*(3), 42-51.

Gagalang, J. L. (2022). Exploring social media use of Filipino learners: How it impacts reading attitudes and competence. Linguistics and Culture Review, 6(on), 275-290. doi:10.21744/lingcure.v6nS2.2034.

Hall, T. (2018). Education, Narrative Technologies and Digital learning. In *Palgrave Macmillan UK eBooks*. https://doi.org/10.1057/978-1-137-32008-7

Hartsell, T. (2017). Digital storytelling: An alternative way of expressing oneself. *International Journal of Information and Communication Technology Education (IJICTE)*, *13*(1), 72-82.

Hennink, M. M., Kaiser, B. N., & Marconi, V. C. (2017). Code saturation versus meaning saturation: how many interviews are enough?. Qualitative health research, 27(4), 591-608.https://doi.org/10.1177/1049732316665344

Hnit, H., & Almanna, A. (2025). Constructing identity through narratives: Personal, social, and digital dimensions. *Social Sciences & Humanities Open*, *12*, 101692.

Jourard, S. M. (1971). Self-disclosure: An experimental analysis of the transparent self. John Wiley & Sons.

Karfelt, B. (2019). Social media: The modern day diary – eCornell #IMPACT. eCornell #IMPACT – Inspiring people across the world through lifelong learning.

Khaleel, M. A. (2021). Ethical considerations in qualitative research: A systematic review. International Journal of Academic Research in Business and Social Sciences, 11(6), 1160–1170.

Khalili, B. G., Quraishi, T., & Fazil, S. (2024). The Influence of social media on Human and Social Communications: A Sociological Study. *Journal of Social and Humanities*, *2*(1), 40-48. https://doi.org/10.59535/jsh.v2i1.246

Krippendorff, K. (2018). Content analysis: An introduction to its methodology. Sage publications.

Lambert, J. (2013). Digital storytelling: Capturing lives, creating community (4th ed.). Routledge.

Laor, T. (2025). Anonymity, Community, and Expression: Unveiling the Dynamics of Confession Pages on Facebook. *Journalism and Media*, *6*(4), 172. https://doi.org/10.3390/journalmedia6040172

Levontin, L., & Yom-Tov, E. (2017). Social media and disclosure: The role of anonymity in self-expression online. Computers in Human Behavior, 75, 543–550. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2017.05.037

Lorenzana, J. A., & Soriano, C. R. R. (2021). The Dynamics of Digital Media in the Philippines-Legacies and Potentials. https://doi.org/10.1177/1329878X211010868

Ma, X., Hancock, J. T., & Naaman, M. (2016). Anonymity, intimacy and self-disclosure in social media. Proceedings of the 2016 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 3857–3868. https://doi.org/10.1145/2858036.2858414

Macbeth, D. (2001). On “reflexivity” in qualitative research: Two readings, and a third. *Qualitative inquiry*, *7*(1), 35-68. https://doi.org/10.1177/107780040100700103

Mirza, H., Mirza, C., & Bellalem, F. (2023). Ethical considerations in qualitative research: Summary guidelines for novice social science researchers.

Naeem, M., Ozuem, W., Howell, K., & Ranfagni, S. (2023). A step-by-step process of thematic analysis to develop a conceptual model in qualitative research. *International journal of qualitative methods*, *22*, 16094069231205789. https://doi.org/10.1177/16094069231205789

Nazarian, D., & Smyth, J. (2008). Expressive Writing. In *Evidence-Based Adjunctive Treatments* (pp. 221-241). Elsevier Inc.. https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-012088520-6.50012-3

Ngai, E. W., Tao, S. S., & Moon, K. K. (2015). Social media research: Theories, constructs, and conceptual frameworks. *International journal of information management*, *35*(1), 33-44. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijinfomgt.2014.09.004

Nguyen, M., Bin, Y. S., & Campbell, A. (2021). The impact of social media on self-disclosure, intimacy, and relationship satisfaction. Computers in Human Behavior, 122, 106819. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2021.106819

Nikou, S., & Aavakare, M. (2021). An assessment of the interplay between literacy and digital Technology in Higher Education. *Education and Information Technologies*, *26*(4), 3893-3915. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10639-021-10451-0

Nowell, L. S., Norris, J. M., White, D. E., & Moules, N. J. (2017). Thematic Analysis: Striving to Meet the Trustworthiness Criteria: Striving to Meet the Trustworthiness

Criteria. *International Journal of Qualitative Methods*, *16*(1). https://doi.org/10.1177/1609406917733847 (Original work published 2017)

Ohler, J. (2013). Digital storytelling in the classroom: New media pathways to literacy, learning, and creativity. Corwin Press.

Perone, A. (2014). Digital storytelling as a form of participatory media culture. Journal of Media Literacy Education, 6(3), 1–12.

Robin, B. R. (2016). The power of digital storytelling to support teaching and learning. Dialnet. https://dialnet.unirioja.es/servlet/articulo?codigo=5772440

Rodriguez, R. L., Padilla, J. R., Montefalcon, M. D., Abisado, M., & Raga, R. (2023, March). The Post Behind Anonymity: A Thematic Discourse Analysis of Facebook Posts from Confession Pages in different Universities in the Philippines. In *2023 11th International Conference on Information and Education Technology (ICIET)* (pp. 529-533). IEEE. DOI:10.1109/ICIET56899.2023.10111104

Rubio-Hurtado, M. J., Fuertes-Alpiste, M., Martínez-Olmo, F., & Quintana, J. (2022). Youths' posting practices on social media for digital storytelling. *Journal of new approaches in educational research*, *11*(1), 97-113. https://doi.org/10.7821/naer.2022.1.729

Sacks, B., Gressier, C., & Maldon, J. (2021). # REALTALK: Facebook Confessions pages as a data resource for academic and student support services at universities. *Learning, Media and Technology*, *46*(4), 550-563. https://doi.org/10.1080/17439884.2021.1946559

Sargeant, J. (2012). Qualitative research part II: Participants, analysis, and quality assurance. *Journal of graduate medical education*, *4*(1), 1-3.

Saunders, B., Sim, J., Kingstone, T., Baker, S., Waterfield, J., Bartlam, B., ... & Jinks, C. (2018). Saturation in qualitative research: exploring its conceptualization and operationalization. Quality & quantity, 52(4), 1893-1907.

Schreier, M. (2012). Qualitative content analysis in practice.

Tagaytay, M., Geonzon, C., Gerasmio, A., Lanos, K., & Salvan, F. (2014). PORTALS OF INSTITUTIONAL CULTURE: UNIVERSITY CONFESSION PAGES IN FOCUS. UIC Research Journal, 20(2), 1-1. https://ejournals.ph/article.php?id=12801

Taralynn Hartsell 2017, Digital Storytelling: An Alternative Way of Expressing Oneself

Tobin, G. A., & Begley, C. M. (2004). Methodological rigour within a qualitative framework. *Journal of advanced nursing*, *48*(4), 388-396.

Voss, C., Shorter, P., Mueller-Coyne, J., & Turner, K. (2023). Screen time, phone usage, and social media usage: Before and during the COVID-19 pandemic. Digital health, 9, 20552076231171510.

Wangchuk, T. (2018). Confessions pages: does it deserve a closer look?. *International Journal of Research in Engineering, IT and Social Sciences*, *8*(5), 8-13.

Williams, B. (2023). How to create a coding sheet for content analysis. Insight7. https://insight7.io/how-to-create-a-coding-sheet-for-content-analysis/

Ye, X., & Gao, H. (2025). Distress disclosure on social media and depressive symptoms among college students: The roles of social comparison and gender. Frontiers in Psychology, 16, 1520066. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1520066

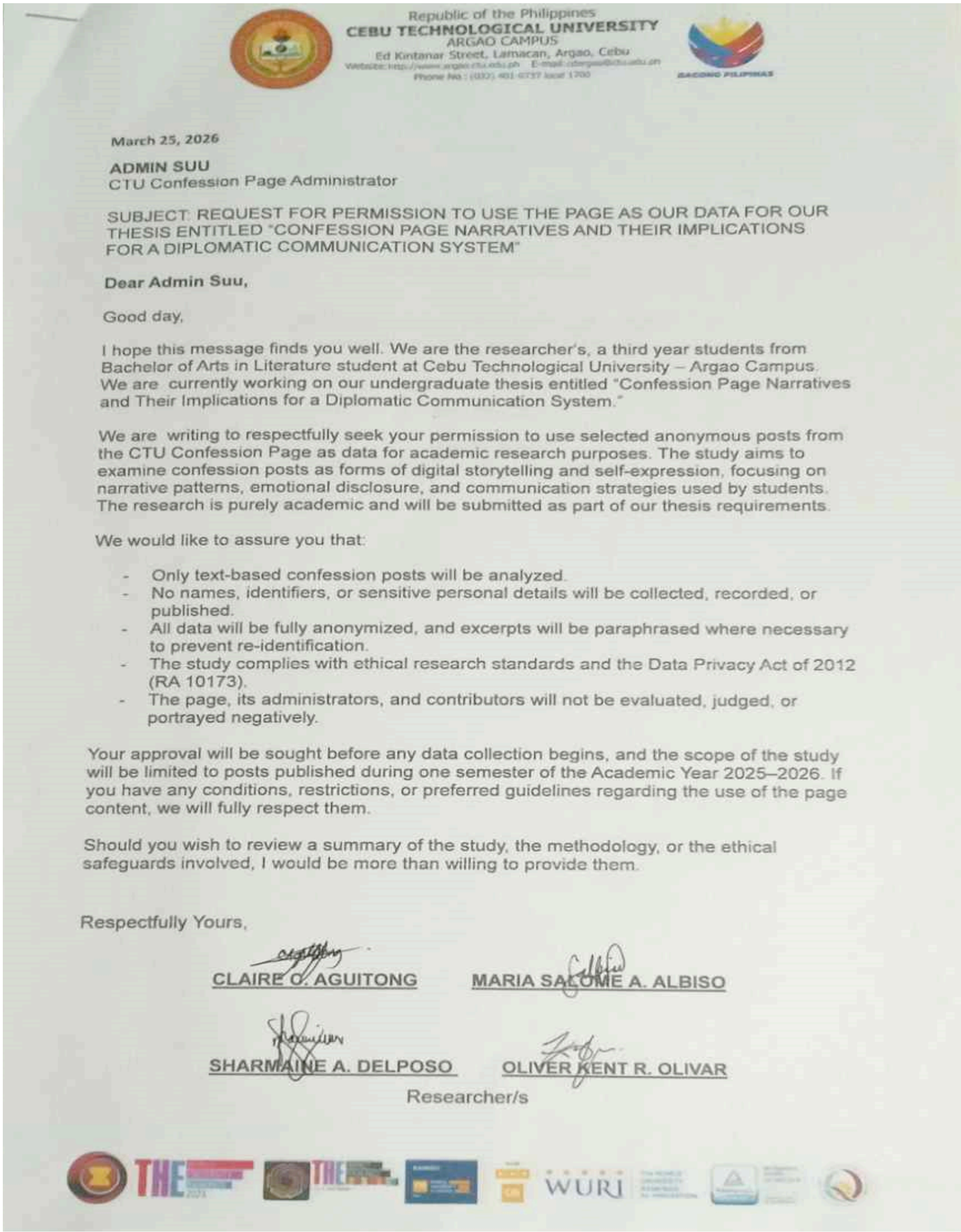
Zani, A. A. A., Norman, A. A., Ghani, N. A., & Sianturi, R. S. (2025). Navigating Social Media: How Offline Ethics, Online Etiquette, and Protection Behavior Shape Self-Disclosure. IEEE Access.

Zhu, Y. (2025). Anonymous intimacy in the digital age: Psychological mechanisms, risks, and potential. Proceedings of the International Conference on Advanced Research in Social Sciences, 2(1), 11–29. https://doi.org/10.33422/icarss.v2i1.1056

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

Approval Letter / Admin Permission Letter



Republic of the Philippines
CEBU TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
ARGAO CAMPUS
Ed Kintanar Street, Lamacan, Argao, Cebu

March 25, 2026

ADMIN SUU
CTU Confession Page Administrator

SUBJECT: REQUEST FOR PERMISSION TO USE THE PAGE AS OUR DATA FOR OUR THESIS ENTITLED "CONFESSION PAGE NARRATIVES AND THEIR IMPLICATIONS FOR A DIPLOMATIC COMMUNICATION SYSTEM"

Dear Admin Suu,

Good day,

I hope this message finds you well. We are the researcher's, a third year students from Bachelor of Arts in Literature student at Cebu Technological University – Argao Campus. We are currently working on our undergraduate thesis entitled "Confession Page Narratives and Their Implications for a Diplomatic Communication System."

We are writing to respectfully seek your permission to use selected anonymous posts from the CTU Confession Page as data for academic research purposes. The study aims to examine confession posts as forms of digital storytelling and self-expression, focusing on narrative patterns, emotional disclosure, and communication strategies used by students. The research is purely academic and will be submitted as part of our thesis requirements.

We would like to assure you that:

- Only text-based confession posts will be analyzed.
- No names, identifiers, or sensitive personal details will be collected, recorded, or published.
- All data will be fully anonymized, and excerpts will be paraphrased where necessary to prevent re-identification.
- The study complies with ethical research standards and the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173).
- The page, its administrators, and contributors will not be evaluated, judged, or portrayed negatively.

Your approval will be sought before any data collection begins, and the scope of the study will be limited to posts published during one semester of the Academic Year 2025–2026. If you have any conditions, restrictions, or preferred guidelines regarding the use of the page content, we will fully respect them.

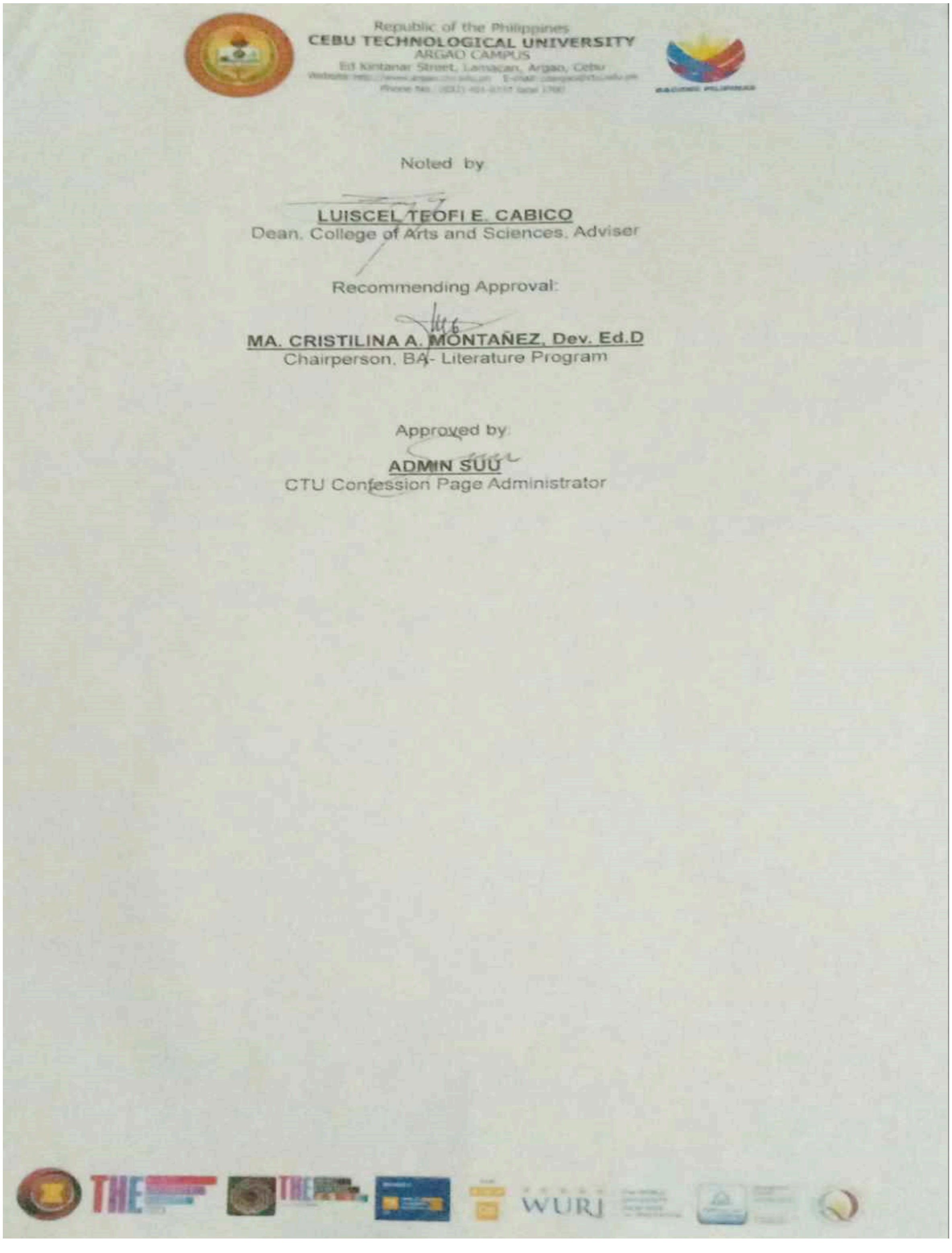
Should you wish to review a summary of the study, the methodology, or the ethical safeguards involved, I would be more than willing to provide them.

Respectfully Yours,

CLAIRE O. AGUITONG **MARIA SALOME A. ALBISO**

SHARMAINE A. DELPOSO **OLIVER KENT R. OLIVAR**

Researcher/s



Republic of the Philippines
CEBU TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
ARGAO CAMPUS
Ed Kintanar Street, Lamacan, Argao, Cebu

Noted by

LUISCEL TEOFI E. CABICO
Dean, College of Arts and Sciences, Adviser

Recommending Approval:

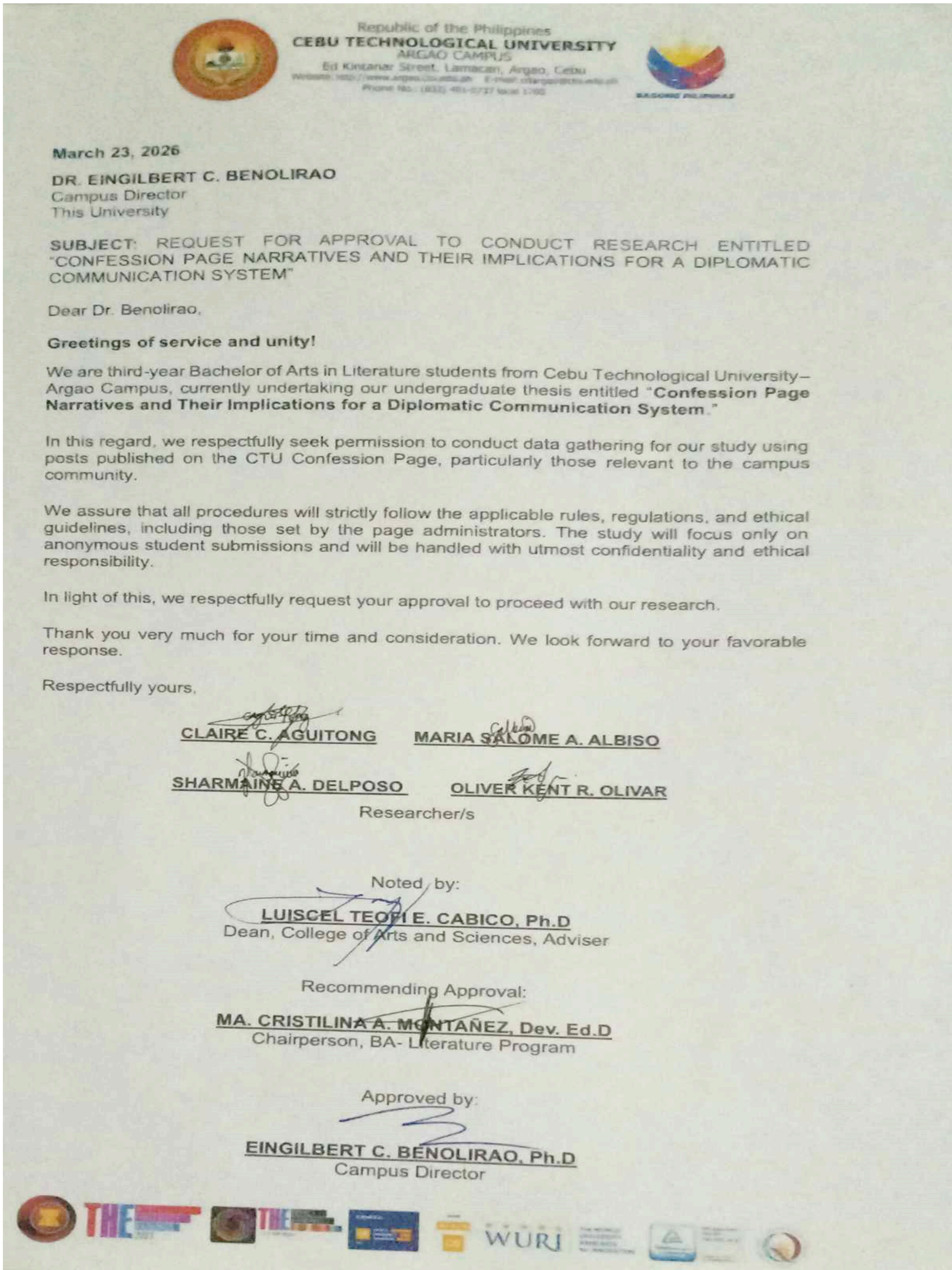
MA. CRISTILINA A. MONTAÑEZ, Dev. Ed.D
Chairperson, BA- Literature Program

Approved by

ADMIN SUU
CTU Confession Page Administrator

APPENDIX B

Transmittal Letter



Republic of the Philippines
CEBU TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
ARGAO CAMPUS
Ed Kintanar Street, Lamacan, Argao, Cebu

March 23, 2026

DR. EINGILBERT C. BENOLIRAO
Campus Director
This University

SUBJECT: REQUEST FOR APPROVAL TO CONDUCT RESEARCH ENTITLED "CONFESSION PAGE NARRATIVES AND THEIR IMPLICATIONS FOR A DIPLOMATIC COMMUNICATION SYSTEM"

Dear Dr. Benolirao,

Greetings of service and unity!

We are third-year Bachelor of Arts in Literature students from Cebu Technological University–Argao Campus, currently undertaking our undergraduate thesis entitled "**Confession Page Narratives and Their Implications for a Diplomatic Communication System**."

In this regard, we respectfully seek permission to conduct data gathering for our study using posts published on the CTU Confession Page, particularly those relevant to the campus community.

We assure that all procedures will strictly follow the applicable rules, regulations, and ethical guidelines, including those set by the page administrators. The study will focus only on anonymous student submissions and will be handled with utmost confidentiality and ethical responsibility.

In light of this, we respectfully request your approval to proceed with our research.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. We look forward to your favorable response.

Respectfully yours,

CLAIRE C. AGUITONG **MARIA SALOME A. ALBISO**

SHARMAINE A. DELPOSO **OLIVER KENT R. OLIVAR**

Researcher/s

Noted by:

LUISCEL TEOFI E. CABICO, Ph.D
Dean, College of Arts and Sciences, Adviser

Recommending Approval:

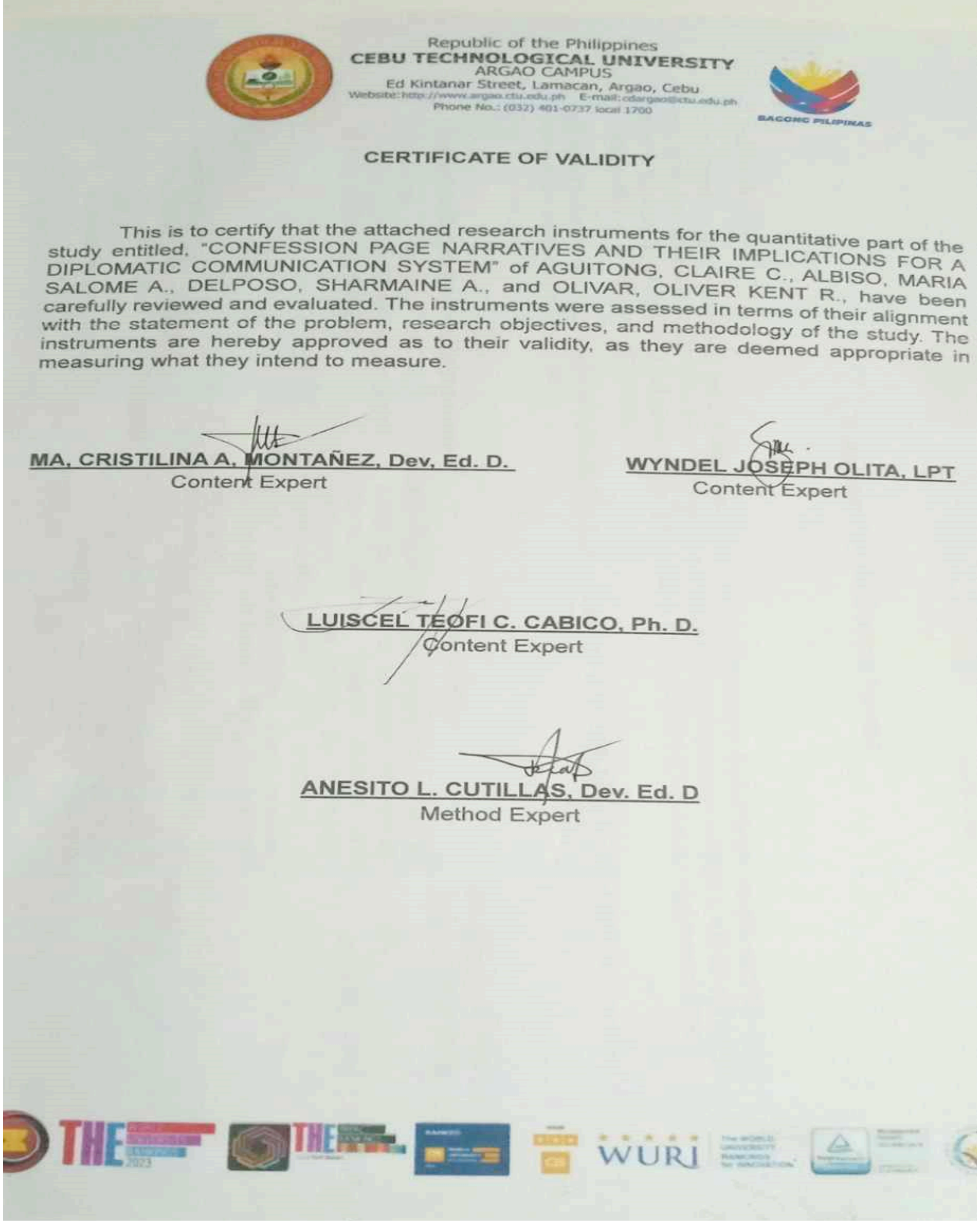
MA. CRISTILINA A. MONTAÑEZ, Dev. Ed.D
Chairperson, BA- Literature Program

Approved by:

EINGILBERT C. BENOLIRAO, Ph.D
Campus Director

APPENDIX C

Certificate Of Validity



Republic of the Philippines
CEBU TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
ARGAO CAMPUS
Ed Kintanar Street, Lamacan, Argao, Cebu
Website: http://www.argao.ctu.edu.ph E-mail: cdargao@ctu.edu.ph
Phone No.: (032) 401-0737 local 1700

BAGONG PILIPINAS

CERTIFICATE OF VALIDITY

This is to certify that the attached research instruments for the quantitative part of the study entitled, "CONFESSION PAGE NARRATIVES AND THEIR IMPLICATIONS FOR A DIPLOMATIC COMMUNICATION SYSTEM" of AGUITONG, CLAIRE C., ALBISO, MARIA SALOME A., DELPOSO, SHARMAINE A., and OLIVAR, OLIVER KENT R., have been carefully reviewed and evaluated. The instruments were assessed in terms of their alignment with the statement of the problem, research objectives, and methodology of the study. The instruments are hereby approved as to their validity, as they are deemed appropriate in measuring what they intend to measure.

MA. CRISTILINA A. MONTAÑEZ, Dev. Ed. D.
Content Expert

WYNDEL JOSEPH OLITA, LPT
Content Expert

LUISCEL TEOFI C. CABICO, Ph. D.
Content Expert

ANESITO L. CUTILLAS, Dev. Ed. D
Method Expert

APPENDIX D

Research Instrument

Name of the Research Instrument: Coding Manual

The primary research instrument used in this study was a researcher-developed coding manual designed to systematically analyze confession page narratives. The coding manual served as a structured guide for identifying, categorizing, and interpreting patterns related to narrative form, thematic content, emotional disclosure, and communication strategies present in the data.

The development of the coding manual was guided by the qualitative data analysis procedures of John W. Creswell, which emphasizes systematic coding and thematic interpretation. The researchers reviewed related literature, previous studies, and theoretical frameworks to develop categories and indicators that could be consistently applied throughout the analysis.

The coding manual was anchored on the study's theoretical foundations, including Sidney Jourard's Self-Disclosure Theory, Joe Lambert's Digital Storytelling Theory, and Walter Fisher's Narrative Paradigm Theory. These theories guided the creation of coding categories related to narrative structure, thematic expression, and emotional disclosure for SOP 1 to SOP 3.

For SOP 4, which focuses on the proposed Diplomatic Communication System, the coding manual was further developed using concepts of indirect communication, conflict management, and strategic discourse. Drawing from the works of Jan Melissen and related communication studies, the researchers developed categories such as softened critique, empathetic framing, reflective positioning, de-escalatory language, and respectful tone to identify diplomatic communication strategies within confession narratives.

Overall, the coding manual was a researcher-constructed instrument grounded in established qualitative methods and communication theories, making it appropriate for analyzing anonymous digital narratives within the academic community.

CODE MANUAL FOR RESEARCH QUESTION 1:

What are the dominant narrative structures present in the anonymous confession posts shared by CTU students?

NARRATIVE STRUCTURE	
Plot/Arc	
Category	**Descriptions/Indicators**
Confessional	This is identified when the content of the post reveals private thoughts, hidden feelings, or personal experiences that are not usually shared openly. Indicators include emotional self-disclosure, admission of personal struggles or secrets, and expressions of vulnerability or need for release.
Adversarial	This is identified when the content of the post expresses conflict, opposition, or tension toward a person, group, or institution. Indicators include complaints or criticism toward others, descriptions of unfair treatment or disagreement, and language showing frustration, resistance, or blame.
Emotional Journey	This is identified when the content of the post shows changes or progression in emotional states across the narrative.

	Indicators include shifts from one feeling to another, reflection on emotional growth or realization, and descriptions of coping, transformation, or resolution.
Form	
Chronological	This is identified when the content of the post presents events, experiences, or thoughts in a time-ordered or sequential manner. Indicators include time markers or sequencing words, step-by-step narration, and clear progression from earlier to later experiences.
Reflective	This is identified when the content of the post focuses on interpretation, realization, or personal meaning derived from past experiences. Indicators include statements of realization or learning, evaluations of past actions or emotions, and explanations of personal understanding or change.
Fragmented	This is identified when the content of the post presents thoughts or experiences in a disjointed, non-linear manner. Indicators include the abrupt shift in topic or emotion, incomplete or short bursts of expression, and minimal transitions between ideas.
Dialogic	This is identified when the content of the post directly addresses another person or presents thoughts in a conversational form. Indicators include use of second-person address, imagined or implied interaction, and question-and-response or conversational phrasing.
Style	
Literary Devices	This is identified when the content of the post uses figurative or expressive language to enhance meaning or emotional impact. Indicators include the use of imagery or descriptive symbolism, comparisons such as metaphor or simile, and exaggerated or creative expression.
Emotionally Charged Language	This is identified when the content of the post uses strong or intense wording to convey powerful emotions. Indicators include dramatic or heightened emotional vocabulary, emphatic or forceful expressions, and language intended to evoke strong feelings.

CODE MANUAL FOR RESEARCH QUESTION 2:

What communicative themes of self-expression and emotional negotiation are prevalent in the anonymous confession narratives of CTU students?

THEMES OF SELF-EXPRESSION	
Category	**Definition/Indicators**
Academic Stress	This is identified when the content of the post describes pressure, anxiety, or difficulty related to academic responsibilities or expectations. Indicators include mention of workload or deadlines, concern about grades or performance, and expressions of burnout or overwhelm from school demands.
Identity Exploration	This is identified when the content of the post reflects questioning, defining, or understanding one's sense of self. Indicators include reflection on personal roles or characteristics, uncertainty or exploration of identity, and attempts to define or understand oneself.
Mental Health	This is identified when the content of the post expresses psychological or emotional distress or efforts to cope with internal struggles. Indicators include mention of anxiety or sadness, description of emotional difficulty or instability, and discussion of coping or mental well-being.
Social or Institutional commentary	This is identified when the content of the post discusses or critiques social environments, group dynamics, or institutional systems. Indicators include evaluation of rules or authority, commentary on fairness or treatment, and observations about social structures or expectations.
DEPTH OF DISCLOSURE	
Category	**Definition/Indicators**
Surface Level	This is identified when the content of the post shares experiences or opinions without deep emotional exposure. Indicators include casual or general statements, limited personal detail, and minimal emotional intensity.
Moderate Level	This is identified when the content of the post shares personal experiences with noticeable but controlled emotional expression Indicators include meaningful personal reflection, moderate emotional openness, and partial disclosure of personal feelings.

Deep Level	This is identified when the content of the post reveals highly personal, intimate, or sensitive experiences with strong emotional exposure. Indicators include intense emotional expression, disclosure of vulnerable or private experiences, and minimal restraint in personal revelation.

CODE MANUAL FOR RESEARCH QUESTION 3:

How does the function of anonymity shape the nature and depth of emotional disclosure in these digital narratives?

ANONYMITY FUNCTION	
Category	**Definition/Indicators**
Explicit References to Anonymity	This is identified when the writer directly acknowledges anonymity or refers to hidden identity as enabling disclosure. Indicators include mention of being anonymous, statements about feeling safe to speak freely, and reducing fear of judgment.
Risk-taking Narratives	This is identified when the content of the post includes socially sensitive, controversial, or personally exposing disclosures enabled by anonymity. Indicators include sharing taboo or stigmatized experiences, revealing information normally withheld, and expressing socially risky opinions.
Emotional Depth	This is identified when anonymity enables unusually intense or uninhibited emotional expression. Indicators include heightened emotional openness, reduced self-censorship, and detailed or raw emotional disclosure.

CODE MANUAL FOR RESEARCH QUESTION 4:

What narrative-based diplomatic communication system can be proposed based on the findings?

DIPLOMATIC COMMUNICATION	
Category	**Definition/Indicators**

Softened Critique	This is identified when criticism or dissatisfaction is expressed in an indirect or moderated manner. Indicators include cautious or hedging language, indirect expression of complaint, and effort to reduce confrontation or blame.
Empathic Framing	This is identified when the content of the post acknowledges or considers the perspectives or feelings of others. Indicators include recognition of shared struggles, expressions of understanding toward others, and balanced or compassionate framing.
Reflective Positioning	This is identified when the writer evaluates their own thoughts, actions, or responsibility with self-awareness. Indicators include self-questioning or self-evaluation, balanced reasoning, and acknowledgement of personal role or limitation.
De-escalatory Language	This is identified when the content of the post attempts to reduce tension or conflict. Indicators include calls for understanding or calm, encouragement of dialogue or resolution, and language promoting restraint or reconciliation.
Respectful Tone	This is identified when the content of the post maintains politeness or courtesy despite emotional or critical content. Indicators include careful or formal wording, controlled emotional expression, and avoidance of insulting or aggressive language.

APPENDIX E

Summarized Confession Posts

All posts were paraphrased to ensure anonymity and comply with ethical data protection standards while preserving thematic meaning.

P01

The post expresses concern about institutional decisions regarding graduation arrangements and associated costs. While critical, the tone remains respectful and framed as a request for reconsideration rather than direct accusation.

P02

The post discusses personal mental health struggles, including anxiety and panic-related experiences. It shifts between distress and reassurance, showing emotional vulnerability and reflection.

P03

The post raises concerns about institutional or academic issues, particularly related to privacy or administrative processes. The writer emphasizes clarification rather than assigning blame.

P04

The post describes academic difficulties encountered during enrollment or academic processing, including complications affecting studies and related responsibilities. The narrative follows a step-by-step explanation of events.

P05

The post combines academic concerns with broader institutional commentary, expressing stress related to school requirements while maintaining a generally reflective tone.

P06

The post reveals personal emotional struggles and long-term internal burdens. It includes identity-related reflection and a strong desire for emotional release and anonymity.

P07

The post expresses emotional distress related to loneliness, self-worth, and interpersonal experiences. It shows deep vulnerability and strong emotional intensity.

P08

The post discusses institutional or academic concerns while balancing empathy for other parties involved. It emphasizes mutual understanding and discourages conflict escalation.

P09

The post highlights social or institutional concerns and encourages respect and understanding among students. It promotes unity and discourages judgment within the community.

P10

The post reflects institutional or academic concerns combined with identity-related reflection. The tone remains careful and communicative rather than confrontational.

P11

The post includes academic stress and direct communication toward an authority figure. It contains strong emotional expressions and references to possible formal action but remains structured.

P12

The post expresses deep emotional experiences, including distress and vulnerability related to past academic or social situations. It reflects both emotional intensity and personal reflection.

P13

The post combines academic stress with financial concerns, highlighting the impact of educational requirements on family resources and personal well-being.

P14

The post reflects on institutional or social experiences with a focus on meaning-making and personal interpretation of events rather than simple narration.

P15

The post focuses on identity affirmation and collective representation, defending a group identity while expressing pride and self-definition.

APPENDIX F

Code-to-Theme Matrix

The Code-to-Theme Matrix presents how the fifteen selected confession posts were coded, categorized, and grouped into final themes. Each post was treated as one unit of analysis. The initial codes were derived from the content analysis coding manual, which focused on narrative structure, self-expression, disclosure depth, anonymity function, and diplomatic communication markers. These codes were then clustered into broader categories to show how the final themes emerged from the data. This matrix serves as part of the study's audit trail by documenting how raw anonymous narratives were transformed into organized findings.

Post	Significant Meaning Unit / Central Concern	Initial Codes	Focused Category	Final Theme	Related SOP
P01	The post raises concern about institutional decisions, student welfare, and fairness while addressing the issue in a careful and questioning manner.	Adversarial; Emotional Journey; Reflective; Dialogic; Academic Stress; Social/Institutional Commentary; Risk-taking Narrative; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing;	Institutional concern expressed through reflective appeal	Social or Institutional Commentary / Reflective-Adversarial Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3, SOP 4

		Reflective Positioning; Respectful Tone			
P02	The post discloses anxiety, emotional distress, and academic pressure, showing how personal struggles are connected to school-related stress.	Emotional Journey; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Mental Health; Academic Stress; Deep Disclosure; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone	Emotional disclosure connected to academic burden	Mental Health Concern / Confessional -Emotional Journey Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3
P03	The post discusses a sensitive concern about confidentiality, trust, and fairness while keeping the tone formal and restrained.	Adversarial; Confessional; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Social/Institutional Commentary; Moderate Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Softened Critique; Reflective	Sensitive institutional concern expressed with caution	Social or Institutional Commentary / Reflective-Adversarial Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3, SOP 4

		Positioning; Respectful Tone			
P04	The post narrates academic difficulty, fear of repeating a subject, and emotional pressure caused by enrollment or school-related concerns.	Emotional Journey; Confessional; Chronological; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Academic Stress; Social/Institutional Commentary; Deep Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone	Academic hardship narrated through emotional sequence	Academic Stress / Chronological Hardship Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3
P05	The post expresses dissatisfaction with institutional responsibility, fairness, or student treatment while framing criticism as concern.	Adversarial; Emotional Journey; Reflective; Chronological; Emotionally Charged Language; Social/Institutional Commentary; Academic Stress; Moderate Disclosure;	Criticism framed as concern for fairness	Social or Institutional Commentary / Reflective-Adversarial Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 4

		Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone			
P06	The post reveals private feelings and emotional struggle while directly requesting anonymity before sharing personal experience.	Confessional; Emotional Journey; Reflective; Fragmented; Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Mental Health; Identity Exploration; Deep Disclosure; Explicit Anonymity; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Reflective Positioning; Respectful Tone	Private emotional struggle protected by anonymity	Mental Health Concern and Identity Exploration / Confessional -Emotional Journey Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3
P07	The post expresses loneliness, emotional neglect, and	Confessional; Emotional Journey; Fragmented; Reflective;	Deep emotional disclosure and search for validation	Mental Health Concern and Identity Exploration /	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3

	self-worth concerns, especially in relation to friendship or belonging.	Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Mental Health; Identity Exploration; Deep Disclosure; Explicit Anonymity; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone		Confessional-Emotional Journey Narrative	
P08	The post discusses academic responsibilities, scheduling concerns, and the need for mutual empathy while addressing others directly.	Adversarial; Emotional Journey; Reflective; Dialogic; Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Academic Stress; Social/Institutional Commentary; Moderate Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing;	Academic and institutional concern expressed through dialogic appeal	Academic Stress and Social Commentary / Dialogic and Appeal-Based Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 4

		Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone			
P09	The post comments on student behavior, community attitude, or peer relations while encouraging support instead of conflict.	Adversarial; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Social/Institutional Commentary; Identity Exploration; Moderate Disclosure; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone	Community reflection and call for constructive behavior	Identity Exploration and Social Commentary / Dialogic and Appeal-Based Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 4
P10	The post reflects leadership, conduct, or responsibility while evaluating the difference between appearance and actual capability.	Adversarial; Confessional; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Social/Institutional Commentary; Identity Exploration; Moderate Disclosure; Risk-taking	Reflective critique of leadership and responsibility	Social or Institutional Commentary / Reflective-Adversarial Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 4

		Narrative; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing; Reflective Positioning; Respectful Tone			
P11	The post narrates academic fear, possible failure, emotional exhaustion, and complaint-related concern toward an authority figure.	Adversarial; Emotional Journey; Chronological; Dialogic; Fragmented; Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Academic Stress; Mental Health; Social/Institutional Commentary; Deep Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Reflective Positioning; Respectful Tone	Academic distress and institutional complaint expressed emotionally	Academic Stress and Mental Health Concern / Chronological Hardship Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3, SOP 4
P12	The post shows a personal emotional journey involving academic	Confessional; Emotional Journey; Chronological; Reflective; Dialogic; Emotionally	Personal pain and identity reflection organized through narrative sequence	Mental Health Concern and Identity Exploration / Confessional-Emotional	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3

	burden, unresolved feelings, and identity-related reflection.	Charged Language; Literary Devices; Academic Stress; Mental Health; Identity Exploration; Deep Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone		Journey Narrative	
P13	The post connects academic participation with financial burden, family budget concerns, and emotional pressure.	Adversarial; Emotional Journey; Chronological; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Academic Stress; Social/Institutional Commentary; Deep Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Emotional Depth; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing; Reflective	Academic difficulty shaped by socioeconomic strain	Academic Stress and Institutional Concern / Chronological Hardship Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 3, SOP 4

		Positioning; Respectful Tone			
P14	The post presents social or institutional criticism together with identity-related reflection and careful positioning.	Adversarial; Confessional; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Social/Institutional Commentary; Identity Exploration; Moderate Disclosure; Risk-taking Narrative; Softened Critique; Empathic Framing; Reflective Positioning; De-escalatory Language; Respectful Tone	Identity-positioned critique of social or institutional concern	Identity Exploration and Social Commentary / Reflective-Adversarial Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2, SOP 4
P15	The post reflects personal identity, belonging, or social recognition while using emotionally expressive and figurative language.	Confessional; Reflective; Emotionally Charged Language; Literary Devices; Identity Exploration; Social/Institutional Commentary; Moderate Disclosure;	Personal reflection connected to belonging and social meaning	Identity Exploration / Confessional-Reflective Narrative	SOP 1, SOP 2

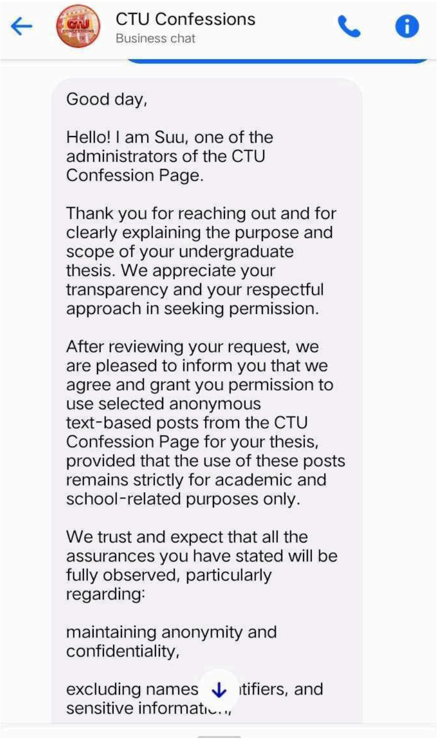
		Reflective Positioning; Respectful Tone			

Summary of Code Clustering

Initial Code Cluster	Included Codes	Emergent Category	Final Theme
Narrative Structure Codes	Emotional Journey, Adversarial, Confessional, Reflective, Chronological, Dialogic, Fragmented, Emotionally Charged Language, Literary Devices	Ways students organize and express anonymous stories	Dominant Narrative Structures
Self-Expression Codes	Academic Stress, Mental Health, Social or Institutional Commentary, Identity Exploration	Main concerns and emotional concerns expressed by students	Communicative Themes of Self-Expression and Emotional Negotiation
Disclosure Codes	Moderate Disclosure, Deep Disclosure, Emotional Depth	Level of personal and emotional revelation	Depth of Emotional Disclosure
Anonymity Codes	Explicit Reference to Anonymity, Risk-taking Narrative, Emotional Depth	How anonymity protects the writer and enables sensitive disclosure	Function of Anonymity in Emotional Disclosure
Diplomatic Communication Codes	Softened Critique, Empathic Framing, Reflective Positioning, De-escalatory Language, Respectful Tone	Careful and indirect communication of concerns	Narrative-Based Diplomatic Communication Markers

APPENDIX E

Documentation



Good day,

Hello! I am Suu, one of the administrators of the CTU Confession Page.

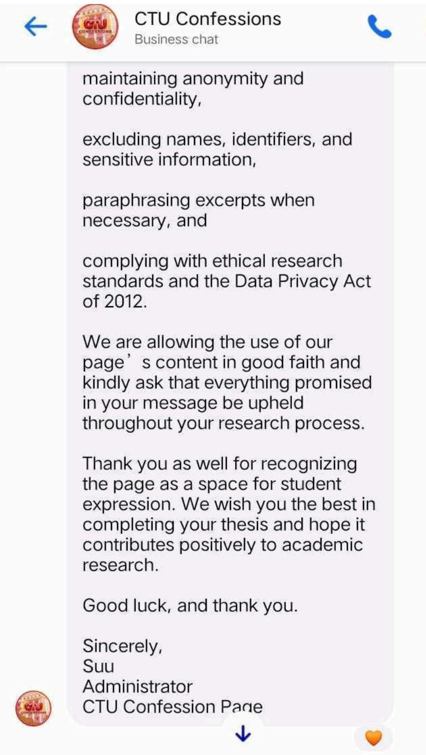
Thank you for reaching out and for clearly explaining the purpose and scope of your undergraduate thesis. We appreciate your transparency and your respectful approach in seeking permission.

After reviewing your request, we are pleased to inform you that we agree and grant you permission to use selected anonymous text-based posts from the CTU Confession Page for your thesis, provided that the use of these posts remains strictly for academic and school-related purposes only.

We trust and expect that all the assurances you have stated will be fully observed, particularly regarding:

maintaining anonymity and confidentiality,

excluding names ↓ itifiers, and sensitive informati,



maintaining anonymity and confidentiality,

excluding names, identifiers, and sensitive information,

paraphrasing excerpts when necessary, and

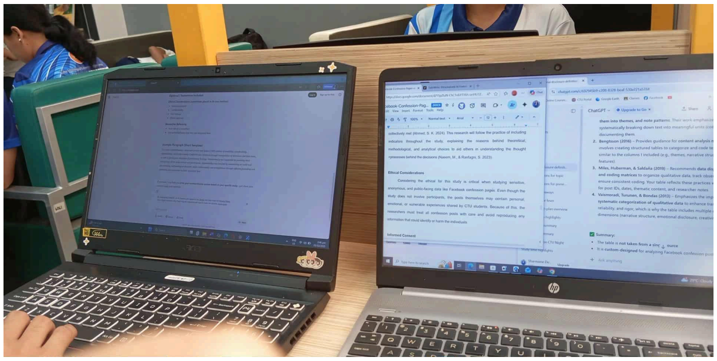
complying with ethical research standards and the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

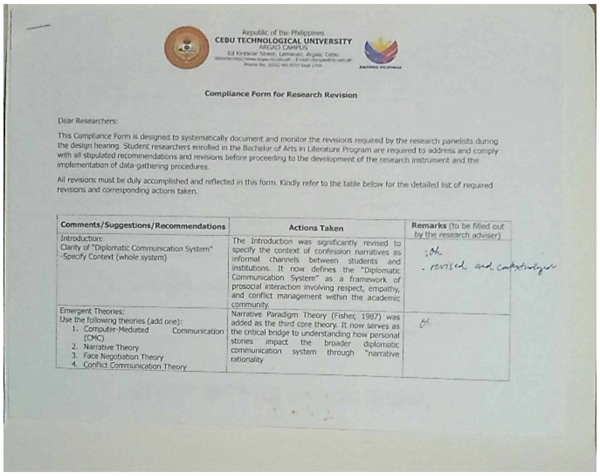
We are allowing the use of our page's content in good faith and kindly ask that everything promised in your message be upheld throughout your research process.

Thank you as well for recognizing the page as a space for student expression. We wish you the best in completing your thesis and hope it contributes positively to academic research.

Good luck, and thank you.

Sincerely,
Suu
Administrator
CTU Confession Page





Republic of the Philippines
CEBU TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
ARGAO CAMPUS
Ed Kintanar Street, Lamacan, Argao, Cebu

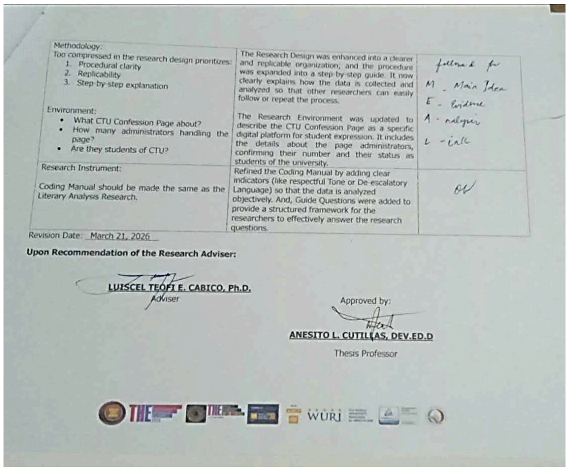
Compliance Form for Research Revision

Dear Researchers:

This Compliance Form is designed to systematically document and monitor the revisions required by the research panelists during the design hearing. Student researchers enrolled in the Bachelor of Arts in Literature Program are required to address and comply with all stipulated recommendations and revisions before proceeding to the development of the research instrument and the implementation of data-gathering procedures.

All revisions must be duly accomplished and reflected in this form. Kindly refer to the table below for the detailed list of required revisions and corresponding actions taken.

Comments/Suggestions/Recommendations	**Actions Taken**	**Remarks** (to be filled out by the research adviser)
Introduction: Clarity of "Diplomatic Communication System" -Specify Context (whole system)	The Introduction was significantly revised to specify the context of confession narratives as informal channels between students and institutions. It now defines the "Diplomatic Communication System" as a framework of prosocial interaction involving respect, empathy, and conflict management within the academic community.	;ok - revised and contextualized
Emergent Theories: Use the following theories (add one): 1. Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC) 2. Narrative Theory 3. Face Negotiation Theory 4. Conflict Communication Theory	Narrative Paradigm Theory (Fisher, 1987) was added as the third core theory. It now serves as the critical bridge to understanding how personal stories impact the broader diplomatic communication system through "narrative rationality	ok



Methodology: Too compressed in the research design prioritizes: 1. Procedural clarity 2. Replicability 3. Step-by-step explanation Environment: • What CTU Confession Page about? • How many administrators handling the page? • Are they students of CTU?	The Research Design was enhanced into a clearer and replicable organization; and the procedure was expanded into a step-by-step guide. It now clearly explains how the data is collected and analyzed so that other researchers can easily follow or repeat the process. The Research Environment was updated to describe the CTU Confession Page as a specific digital platform for student expression. It includes the details about the page administrators, confirming their number and their status as students of the university.	followed for M - Main Idea E - Evidence A - nalysis L - ink
Research Instrument: Coding Manual should be made the same as the Literary Analysis Research.	Refined the Coding Manual by adding clear indicators (like respectful Tone or De-escalatory Language) so that the data is analyzed objectively. And, Guide Questions were added to provide a structured framework for the researchers to effectively answer the research questions.	ok

Revision Date: March 21, 2026

Upon Recommendation of the Research Adviser:

LUISCEL TEOFI E. CABICO, Ph.D.
Adviser

Approved by:

ANESITO L. CUTILLAS, DEV.ED.D
Thesis Professor

APPENDIX F

Audit Trail

Title: Confession Page Narratives and Their Implications for a Diplomatic Communication System

Researchers: Claire Aguitong, Maria Salome Albiso, Sharmaine Delposo, and Oliver Kent Olivar

Institution: Cebu Technological University – Argao Campus

Degree: Bachelor of Arts in Literature

Academic Year: 2025–2026

1. Conceptualization Phase

- Date/Period: November 2025
- Activity: Identification of the study focus on CTU Confession Page narratives as forms of indirect communication.
- Main concern: To examine how anonymous posts reveal student concerns, emotional disclosure, and institutional tensions.
- Theoretical anchors: Digital Storytelling Theory, Self-Disclosure Theory, and Narrative Paradigm Theory.

2. Proposal and Design Phase

- Date/Period: December 2025
- Research design: Qualitative content analysis.
- Data source: Anonymous text-based confession posts from the CTU Confession

Page.

- Sampling method: Purposive sampling.
- Unit of analysis: Each selected confession post.
- Instrument: Content analysis coding manual.
- Validation: Coding manual reviewed/validated by adviser or research panel.

3. Data Screening and Selection Phase

- Date/Period: March 2026
- Initial pool: Approximately 100 confession posts.
- Inclusion criteria: Posts with at least 100 words, original text-based content, and campus-related or personal narrative relevance.
- Exclusion criteria: Posts with identifiable names, purely image-based content, shared content, or brief non-narrative updates.
- Final sample: 15 selected anonymous confession posts.

4. Data Preparation and Anonymization Phase

- Date/Period: April 2026
- Activity: Posts were copied, reviewed, paraphrased, and anonymized.
- Ethical action: Names, programs, locations, and other identifiable details were removed or modified.
- Purpose: To protect privacy while preserving the meaning of the narratives.

5. Coding and Analysis Phase

- Date/Period: May 2026
- Coding approach: Inductive coding guided by the coding manual.
- Coding categories: Narrative structure, thematic content, depth of disclosure, anonymity function, and diplomatic communication markers.
- Analytical process: Codes were grouped into broader thematic categories.
- Checking process: Coding disagreements were resolved through researcher discussion or consultation.

6. Theme Development Phase

- Date/Period: May 2026
- Activity: Recurring patterns were clustered into final themes.
- Major findings: Emotional journey, adversarial and confessional plots, academic stress, mental health concerns, institutional commentary, identity exploration, and diplomatic communication strategies.
- Purpose: To connect the coded data to the statement of the problem.

7. Output Development Phase

- Date/Period: May 2026
- Output: Narrative Diplomatic Communication System.
- Basis: Findings on anonymity, emotional disclosure, institutional signals, and diplomatic communication markers.
- Purpose: To propose a communication framework that can help interpret anonymous student narratives as informal institutional feedback.

Phase	Activity	Evidence
Conceptualization Phase	Identified CTU Confession Page narratives as the focus of the study	Approved title and SOP
Proposal and Design Phase	Selected qualitative content analysis and prepared coding manual	Research design and instrument
Data Screening Phase	Screened around 100 posts and selected 15 based on criteria	Screening checklist
Data Preparation Phase	Removed names, courses, locations, and identifying details	Anonymized post copies
Coding and Analysis Phase	Applied codes for narrative structure, themes, disclosure depth, anonymity, and diplomatic markers	Coding manual and coded matrix
Theme Development Phase	Grouped codes into broader themes	Code-to-Theme Matrix
Output Development Phase	Developed the Narrative Diplomatic Communication System	Proposed output

CURRICULUM VITAE

I. PERSONAL DATA

Name: **CLAIRE C. AGUITONG**
Address: Upper Balud, Dalaguete, Cebu
Date of Birth: September 11, 2004
Age: 21
Place of Birth: VSMMC Cebu City, Cebu
Civil Status: Single
Parents: Cenon Y. Aguitong
Marciana C. Aguitong

II. EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Tertiary: **BACHELOR OF ARTS IN LITERATURE**
Cebu Technological University - Argao Campus
Lamacan, Argao, Cebu
2023 – Present

Secondary: SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL (HUMSS)
Dalageute National High School
Poblacion, Dalaguete, Cebu
2023

JUNIOR HIGH SCHOOL
Dalaguete National High School
Poblacion, Dalaguete, Cebu
2021

Elementary: Balud Elementary School
Balud, Dalaguete, Cebu
2017

I. PERSONAL DATA

Name: **SHARMAINE A. DELPOSO**
Address: Jolomaynon, Dalaguete, Cebu
Date of Birth: December 03, 2004
Age: 21
Place of Birth: Cebu Doctor’s Hospital
Civil Status: Single
Parents: Gregorio B. Delposo
Rita A. Delposo

II. EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Tertiary: **BACHELOR OF ARTS IN LITERATURE**
Cebu Technological University - Argao Campus
Lamacan, Argao, Cebu
2023 – Present

Secondary: SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL (HUMSS)
Dalaguete National High School
Poblacion, Dalaguete, Cebu
2023

JUNIOR HIGH SCHOOL
Dalaguete National High School
Poblacion, Dalaguete, Cebu
2021

Elementary: Jolomaynon Elementary School
Jolomaynon, Dalaguete, Cebu
2017

I. PERSONAL DATA

Name: **MARIA SALOME A. ALBISO**
Address: Catang, Argao, Cebu
Date of Birth: September 09, 2004
Age: 21
Place of Birth: ICKMH, Argao Cebu
Civil Status: Single
Parents: Clementino E. Albiso
Pamela A. Albiso

II. EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Tertiary: **BACHELOR OF ARTS IN LITERATURE**
Cebu Technological University - Argao Campus
Lamacan, Argao, Cebu
2023 – Present

Secondary: HIGH SCHOOL (GAS - ABM Elective)
Usmad National High School
Usmad, Argao, Cebu
2022

JUNIOR HIGH SCHOOL
Usmad National High School
Usmad, Argao, Cebu
2020

Elementary: Usmad Elementary School
Usmad, Argao, Cebu
2016

I. PERSONAL DATA

Name: **OLIVER KENT R. OLIVAR**
Address: Bahay Sibonga, Cebu
Date of Birth: December 13, 2004
Age: 21
Place of Birth: Sibonga, Cebu
Civil Status: Single
Parents: Maricel R. Olivar
Jonathan A. Olivar

II. EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Tertiary: **BACHELOR OF ARTS IN LITERATURE**
Cebu Technological University – Argao Campus
Lamacan Argao, Cebu
2023 – Present

Secondary: SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL (HUMSS – Strand)
VANS Private Technical School Inc.
Poblacion II, Carcar City, Cebu
2023

JUNIOR HIGH SCHOOL
Sibonga, National High School
Poblacion, Sibonga, Cebu
2020

Elementary: Sibonga Central Elementary School
Poblacion Sibonga, Cebu
2017